

ANGLAIS • TLE TECH

ANGLAIS – CLASSE DE TERMINALE TECHNIQUE

LEÇON N02

ECONOMIC LIFE AND OCCUPATIONS

DURÉE CONSEILLÉE : 13 SÉANCES (FICHE DE PROGRESSION HARMONISÉE)

DANS CETTE LEÇON

Cette leçon développe les compétences en anglais technique pour la vie économique : évaluer les besoins des consommateurs, comparer prix et qualité, maîtriser les services bancaires, et rédiger des textes argumentés. Elle intègre grammaire (comparaisons, adverbess temporels, phrases complexes, préférences) et vocabulaire spécialisé à travers des contextes camerounais concrets.

- À la fin de cette leçon, je sais évaluer les besoins des consommateurs et présenter les ressources communautaires en anglais en utilisant le vocabulaire approprié.
- Je sais comparer des prix et des qualités pour déterminer les meilleurs achats en employant les formes de comparaison (double, égalité, degré) et les adverbess temporels (for, since, ago, after, afterwards).
- Je sais comprendre des textes oraux et écrits sur l'économie de consommation et les services bancaires au Cameroun.
- Je sais construire des phrases complexes par coordination et subordination pour exprimer des idées nuancées sur la gestion financière.
- Je sais exprimer mes préférences bancaires et justifier mes choix avec des arguments structurés.
- Je sais rédiger une composition cohérente sur l'utilisation des services bancaires (ouverture de compte, crédit, épargne) en respectant les conventions de l'écrit formel.



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OBJECTIFS DE LA LEÇON

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- Je sais rédiger une composition cohérente sur l'utilisation des services bancaires (ouverture de compte, crédit, épargne) en respectant les conventions de l'écrit formel.
- Je sais appliquer ces notions à des situations réelles de la vie courante camerounaise (marché, banque, coopérative) et justifier ma démarche.

PRÉREQUIS

- Maîtrise des comparatifs de supériorité, infériorité et égalité de base (4ème/3ème).
- Utilisation du present perfect avec for/since vs past simple avec ago (début 1ère).

- Vocabulaire de base sur l'argent, les achats et la banque (1ère).
- Construction de phrases simples et coordonnées (and, but, or) (1ère).
- Rédaction d'un paragraphe structuré (introduction, développement, conclusion) (1ère).

1 ASSESSING CONSUMER NEEDS & COMMUNITY RESOURCES

1.1 Introduction : Marie's Dilemma

Imagine Douala, on a busy Monday morning. **Marie** wants to open a small neighbourhood grocery shop (une épicerie de quartier) in Bonabéri. She has a little capital, big dreams, and many questions. She hesitates between two banks for a microcredit (un microcrédit), she does not know how to assess the real needs of her future customers, and she cannot compare the prices of wholesalers (grossistes) efficiently. Her cousin **Jean**, on the other hand, has just opened a savings account (un compte épargne) without understanding the hidden fees (les frais cachés).

Problematic : How can we help Marie and Jean take the best economic decisions for their community? This lesson gives you the linguistic and practical tools to **analyse**, **compare**, **argue** and **write** in English in authentic Cameroonian financial situations. In this first section, we focus on the very first step of any economic project : **assessing consumer needs and community resources**.

1.2 What Is a Needs Assessment ?

Intuition first. Before you buy stock for a shop, you must know what people around you actually want to buy. If Marie fills her shelves with expensive imported rice but her neighbours can only afford local rice, her shop will fail. A good businessperson first listens to the community, then acts.

DÉFINITION Needs assessment

A **needs assessment** (évaluation des besoins) is a systematic process of identifying the gaps (écarts) between the current situation and the desired situation for a target population (population cible). It answers three questions : What do people have ? What do people need ? What is missing ?

In Cameroon, the main consumer needs concern four sectors :

- **Food** (alimentation) : rice, oil, soap, cassava, plantain, fish ;
- **Health** (santé) : medicines, health centres, clean water ;
- **Education** (éducation) : school fees, uniforms, textbooks ;
- **Transport** (transport) : taxis, motorbikes (bendskins), bus fares.

MÉTHODE How to conduct a needs assessment in 5 steps

1. Design a survey (concevoir une enquête) : write a short **questionnaire** with clear questions (age, income, daily expenses, preferred products).

2. Identify the target group (groupe cible) : for Marie, the households within 500 metres of her shop.
3. Collect data (collecter les données) : interview people at the **local market**, at home, or at the GIE meeting.
4. Analyse the results (analyser) : calculate percentages, compare prices, rank the **priorities**.
5. Write a report and act (rédiger un rapport et agir) : present conclusions and take decisions (what to stock, at what price).

1. Survey
questionnaire

2. Data collection
interviews

3. Analysis
percentages

4. Report
conclusions

5. Action
decisions

The needs assessment flow : from the field survey at the local market to concrete economic action for the community.

1.3 Key Vocabulary : Assessing Needs and Community Resources

English	Meaning / example	French
needs assessment	a needs assessment of the neighbourhood	évaluation des besoins
survey / questionnaire	to carry out a survey in the market	enquête / questionnaire
target group	women aged 25–45 are our target group	groupe cible
community resources	tontines, GIEs and cooperatives	ressources communautaires
local market	the Mokolo market in Yaoundé	marché local
purchasing power	low purchasing power of households	pouvoir d'achat
priority	Food is the first priority.	priorité
affordability	the affordability of basic goods	caractère abordable
accessibility	accessibility of health services	accessibilité
household	an average household of six people	ménage

ATTENTION False friends and tricky words

Do not confuse **affordability** (can people pay?) with **accessibility** (can people reach it?). A product can be affordable but not accessible if the shop is too far. Also, to achieve

means « réaliser un objectif », not « acheter » (to buy / to purchase).

1.4 Grammar Focus : Advanced Forms of Comparison

To analyse survey data, you must compare prices, incomes and needs precisely. English offers three powerful tools beyond the simple comparative.

1. Equality : as ... as / the same ... as. Use as + adjective + as to say two things are equal : « Local rice is **as expensive as** imported rice in some markets. » Use the same + noun + as : « This wholesaler offers **the same quality as** the other one. »

2. Double comparatives : the more ..., the more ... This structure shows that two things change together.

MÉTHODE Building a double comparative

Use : The + comparative + subject + verb, the + comparative + subject + verb.

Example : The higher the price, the lower the demand. (Plus le prix est élevé, plus la demande est faible.)

EXEMPLE Double comparatives in context

- The more customers Marie interviews, the better she understands their needs.
- The cheaper the goods, the faster they sell.
- The more you save, the safer your business becomes.

3. Degree : far more, slightly less, much better. Intensify or soften a comparison with adverbs of degree :

Degree word	Example
far / much + comparative	Imported rice is far more expensive than local rice.
slightly / a little + comparative	Soap is slightly cheaper in Douala than in Yaoundé.
much / far + better/worse	The cooperative's oil is much better than the market oil.
not nearly as ... as	The new shop is not nearly as busy as the Central Market.

ATTENTION as ... as or so ... as ?

A frequent error : confusing as ... as (equality, affirmative) and so ... as (used only in negative sentences). In the affirmative, always use as ... as : « Local rice is as good as imported

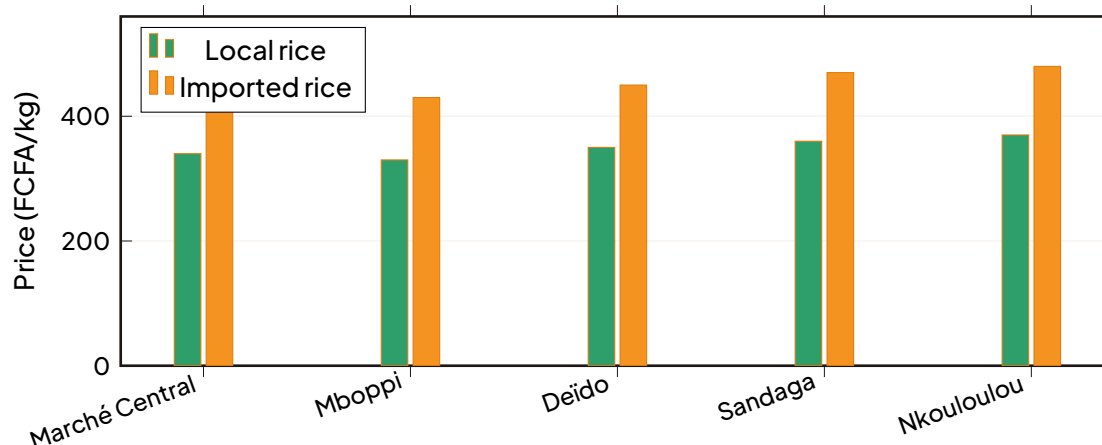
rice» — never «so good as» in an affirmative sentence. Negative : «It is not as/so expensive as before.»

1.5 Analysing Real Data : Prices in Douala Markets

Numbers speak. According to INS and MINCOMMERCE data, the prices of basic goods (denrées de base) vary strongly from one market to another. Let us study the price of rice — the most consumed cereal in urban Cameroon.

EXAMPLE A key figure

In 2023, the average price of local rice in Cameroon was 350 FCFA/kg, against 450 FCFA/kg for imported rice (source : MINCOMMERCE). Local rice is therefore much cheaper than imported rice, and the gap explains why low-income households prefer it.



Comparative bar chart : prices of local vs imported rice (FCFA/kg) in five Douala markets (INS 2023, indicative values). Imported rice is consistently far more expensive.

Reading the chart. In every market, imported rice is far more expensive than local rice. The gap is largest in Nkouloulou (about 110 FCFA/kg) and smallest in Mboppi. We can say : The poorer the neighbourhood, the wider the price gap matters for the household budget. For Marie, the conclusion is clear : stocking affordable local rice should be a **priority**.

1.6 Community Resources : The Informal Economy at Work

A community is not only consumers ; it is also **resources**. In Cameroon, economic life relies on powerful solidarity networks :

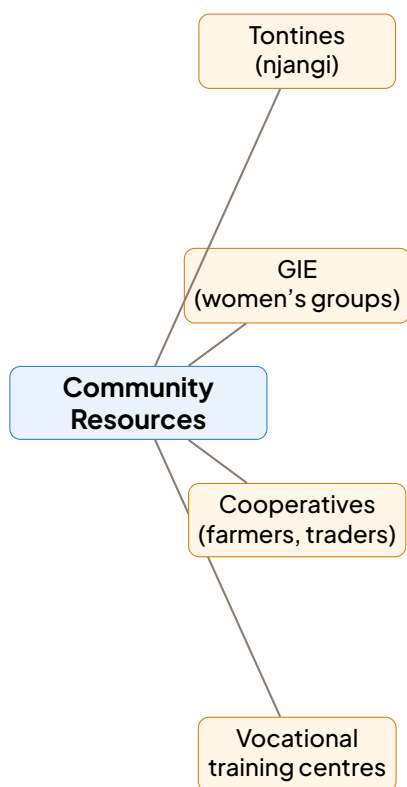
- **Tontines (njangi)** : rotating savings groups where members contribute monthly and receive

the pot in turn;

- **GIE** (Groupement d'Intérêt Économique) : legal economic interest groupings, often run by women (shea butter, cassava processing, tailoring);
- **Cooperatives** (coopératives) : farmers or traders pooling production and sales;
- **Vocational training centres** (centres de formation professionnelle) : they train young people in trades and entrepreneurship.

LESAVAIS-TU ? Tontines : giants of informal finance

Tontines (njangi) manage more than 500 billion FCFA per year in Cameroon. They are the first source of informal financing for small and medium enterprises (SMEs), far ahead of microfinance institutions. For many traders at the Central Market of Yaoundé, the tontine is the bank.



Mind map of community resources in Cameroon : four pillars that finance, train and organise local economic life.

1.7 Speaking Practice : Role-Plays at the Market

EXEMPLE Model dialogue : interviewing a trader at the Central Market, Yaoundé

Enumerator (E) : Good morning, Madam. I am carrying out a survey on consumer needs in this neighbourhood. May I ask you a few questions?

Trader (T) : Of course, young lady.

E : What products do your customers buy most?

T : Rice, oil and soap. The cheaper the product, the faster it sells.

E : Is local rice as popular as imported rice?

T : Much more popular! It is far cheaper, and the quality is now as good as the imported one.

E : What is your customers' main difficulty?

T : Their purchasing power. Salaries are low, so affordability is the first priority.

Your turn. In pairs, prepare a role-play : one student is an enumerator, the other is either a trader at the Marché Central or the leader of a women's GIE. Use at least three target vocabulary words and two comparison structures. Then, each group presents a **3-minute oral synthesis** (synthèse orale) of its findings with a visual support (table or chart) : state the target group, the three main needs, the price data, and one recommendation.

1.8 Practice

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 1 Comparing prices with degree words

Complete with the correct form : Imported rice is ... (expensive) local rice, and it sells ... (slowly).

SOLUTION

Solution. We compare two items with a degree adverb : Imported rice is far more expensive than local rice, and it sells much more slowly. Note : expensive is a long adjective, so the comparative is more expensive ; slowly takes more slowly.

EXERCICE 1 Grammar : comparisons

1. Rewrite with a double comparative : « When prices rise, demand falls. »
2. Correct the mistake : « Local rice is so cheap as imported rice. »
3. Complete : « The new market is ... (big) the old one, but ... (not / clean). »
4. Translate : « Plus on épargne tôt, plus le projet devient possible. »

CORRIGÉ Exercice : comparisons

1. The higher the prices, the lower the demand.
2. Local rice is as cheap as imported rice. (In the affirmative, use as ... as, not so ... as.)
3. The new market is bigger than the old one, but not as clean as it.
4. The earlier you save, the more possible the project becomes.

À RETENIR Key points of this section

- A **needs assessment** identifies the gap between the current and the desired situation for a target group, in five steps : survey, data collection, analysis, report, action.
- Master the three comparison tools : equality (as ... as), double comparatives (the more ..., the more ...) and degree (far more, slightly less, much better).
- Community resources — tontines, GIEs, cooperatives, training centres — are the backbone of Cameroon's local economy.
- Always support your oral synthesis with data : prices, percentages, priorities.

2 SMART SHOPPING : COMPARING PRICES & QUALITY FOR BEST BUYS

In the previous section, we learned how to **assess consumer needs** and identify **community resources**. Now that we know what we need and where to find it, we must master the skill of **smart shopping** : getting the best **value for money**. Whether you are buying maize flour for your family in Yaoundé or spare parts for a workshop in Douala, the principles remain the same : **compare unit prices**, **check quality**, and **negotiate wisely**.

2.1 Listening : Radio Ads & Price Comparisons

EXPÉRIENCE Listening to Radio Advertisements

Context : You hear two radio advertisements. One is from a supermarket promoting a **discount** on wholesale packs. The other is from a traditional market vendor (for example at Marché Central in Yaoundé or Marché Mboppi in Douala) advertising fresh produce at **retail** prices.

Task : Listen carefully and fill in the table below with the **key information**.

Criteria	Supermarket Ad	Market Vendor Ad
Product		
Price (FCFA)		
Quantity / Pack size		
Unit price (FCFA/kg or FCFA/L)		
Expiry date mentioned?		
Quality check / Certification (ANOR?)		
Special offer (bargain , loyalty card?)		

Follow-up : Which source offers the most **cost-effective** solution for a family of five for one month? Justify your answer using the information in your table.

DÉFINITION Unit Price

The **unit price** is the cost per standard unit of measure (kilogram, litre, metre, piece). It allows a real comparison between different pack sizes (e.g. a 500 g box versus a 2 kg bag) or different sellers (supermarket versus market).

$$\text{Unit Price} = \frac{\text{Total Price}}{\text{Total Quantity (in standard units)}}$$

Example : A 2,5 kg bag of rice costs 2 500 FCFA. Unit price = $2\,500 \div 2,5 = 1\,000$ FCFA/kg.

ATTENTION Packaging Can Be Misleading

A bigger pack is not always cheaper per kilogram. Some sellers use large packaging to attract buyers while the **unit price** remains high. Always calculate the unit price before deciding. Also check the **expiry date** : a cheap product that expires tomorrow is not a **bargain**.

2.2 Vocabulary : Smart Shopping Terms

English Term	Definition / Context	French Gloss
Bargain	A thing bought for less than its usual price.	Bonne affaire
Discount	A reduction in the usual price.	Réduction / Remise
Wholesale	Selling goods in large quantities at low prices (to retailers).	Vente en gros
Retail	Selling goods in small quantities directly to consumers.	Vente au détail
Unit price	Price per kg, litre, metre... (see Definition box).	Prix unitaire
Quality check	Inspecting goods before buying (freshness, seal, label).	Contrôle qualité
Expiry date / Best before	Date after which a product should not be eaten or used.	Date de péremption
Value for money	Good quality relative to the price paid.	Rapport qualité-prix
Cost-effective	Producing good results without costing too much.	Rentable / Économique
Budget-friendly	Cheap enough not to exceed planned spending.	Abordable
Bulk purchase	Buying large quantities at once (often with a discount).	Achat en gros
Receipt	Paper proof of payment given by the seller.	Reçu / Facture
To negotiate / To bargain	To discuss the price with the seller to reduce it.	Négocier / Marchander

2.3 Grammar : Time Adverbs (for, since, ago, after, afterwards)

These adverbs situate actions in time. Mastering them is crucial for describing price trends, shopping habits, or past transactions.

PROPRIÉTÉ Time Adverbs : Forms & Uses

- **FOR** + duration (How long?) : I have shopped at this market for 10 years. (depuis / pendant 10 ans). Used with the present perfect for an action continuing until now.
- **SINCE** + starting point (When did it start?) : Prices have risen since 2020. (depuis 2020). Also used with the present perfect.
- **AGO** + past moment, placed after the duration, with the Past Simple : I bought this chicken two days ago. (il y a deux jours).
- **AFTER** + noun / gerund / clause (preposition or conjunction) : After the purchase, I

checked the receipt. / After paying, I left. / After I paid, I left.

- AFTERWARDS (adverb, stands alone) : We compared prices. Afterwards, we decided. (ensuite, par la suite).

ATTENTION After vs Afterwards

Do not confuse them!

- After connects two events and is always followed by a noun, a gerund or a clause : After lunch, we went shopping. / After we ate, we went shopping.
- Afterwards modifies the verb and stands alone, usually at the beginning or end of the sentence : We had lunch. Afterwards, we went shopping.
- Never say : “Afterwards lunch” or “Afterwards we ate, we went shopping.”
- Never say : “I have seen him two days ago.” With ago, always use the Past Simple : I saw him two days ago.

EXERCICE 2 Complete with for, since, ago, after or afterwards

1. Fuel prices have been high _____ the increase in fuel prices in 2023.
2. I waited _____ 20 minutes at the checkout _____ paying.
3. She bought that fabric three months _____.
4. We compared the offers. _____, we chose the local brand.
5. _____ checking the **expiry date**, put the milk in the fridge.
6. They have sold second-hand clothes in this market _____ fifteen years.

CORRIGÉ Exercice : Time Adverbs

1. since (starting point + present perfect).
2. for (duration) ; after (after + gerund “paying”).
3. ago (past moment + Past Simple).
4. Afterwards (adverb standing alone after a full stop).
5. After (after + gerund “checking”).
6. for (duration + present perfect).

2.4 Practical Activity : Comparing Three Offers of Maize Flour

MÉTHODE How to Determine the **Best Buy** (Quality and Price)

Follow these steps before any important purchase :

1. Identify your need : which product, which quantity, for how many people ?
2. Collect the offers : note the price and the quantity of each seller (supermarket, market, wholesaler).
3. Calculate the unit price of each offer : divide the total price by the quantity in standard units (kg or L).
4. Check the quality : read the label, verify the **expiry date**, look for certification (for example ANOR standards in Cameroon), inspect freshness.
5. Compare and rank the offers from the cheapest to the most expensive per unit.
6. Decide and justify : the **best buy** is the offer with the lowest unit price among products of acceptable quality — not simply the cheapest product.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 2 Worked Example : Which Bag of Maize Flour Is the Best Buy ?

Statement. A housewife in Bafoussam finds three offers of maize flour :

Offer	Quantity	Total Price	Quality observation
A (market vendor)	1 kg	650 FCFA	Fresh, well dried
B (supermarket)	5 kg	3 500 FCFA	Certified, expires in 2 months
C (wholesaler)	10 kg	6 000 FCFA	Certified, expires in 6 months

Calculate the unit price of each offer and determine the **best buy** for a family that consumes 10 kg per month.

SOLUTION

Solution.

$$\text{Offer A : } 650 \div 1 = 650 \text{ FCFA/kg}$$

$$\text{Offer B : } 3\,500 \div 5 = 700 \text{ FCFA/kg}$$

$$\text{Offer C : } 6\,000 \div 10 = 600 \text{ FCFA/kg}$$

Ranking (cheapest to most expensive per kg) : C (600 FCFA/kg) < A (650 FCFA/kg) < B (700 FCFA/kg).

Conclusion : Offer C is the **best buy** : it has the lowest **unit price** (600 FCFA/kg), it is certi-

fied, and its **expiry date** (6 months) is long enough for a family consuming 10 kg per month. Offer B is the most expensive per kilogram despite its attractive packaging. Note that Offer A would be the best choice only for a buyer who cannot spend 6 000 FCFA at once : a **best buy** must also respect the buyer's budget.

EXERCICE 3 Your Turn : Best Buy at the Shop

A school canteen in Bafoussam wants to buy cooking oil. Three offers are available :

Offer	Quantity	Total Price
X	1 litre	1 300 FCFA
Y	5 litres	6 000 FCFA
Z	20 litres	22 000 FCFA

1. Calculate the **unit price** (FCFA per litre) of each offer.
2. Rank the offers from the cheapest to the most expensive per litre.
3. Which offer is the **best buy** for the canteen? Justify your answer in two or three sentences using the vocabulary of the lesson (unit price, value for money, bulk purchase, cost-effective).

CORRIGÉ Exercice : Best Buy at the Shop

1. Offer X : $1\,300 \div 1 = 1\,300$ FCFA/L. Offer Y : $6\,000 \div 5 = 1\,200$ FCFA/L. Offer Z : $22\,000 \div 20 = 1\,100$ FCFA/L.
2. $Z (1\,100 \text{ FCFA/L}) < Y (1\,200 \text{ FCFA/L}) < X (1\,300 \text{ FCFA/L})$.
3. Offer Z is the **best buy** : it has the lowest **unit price** (1 100 FCFA/L). This **bulk purchase** is **cost-effective** for a canteen that uses large quantities of oil, so it offers the best **value for money**.

À RETENIR Key Points of Section 2

- The **unit price** = total price $\div$ quantity : the essential tool for comparing offers.
- The **best buy** combines low unit price, acceptable quality (label, **expiry date**, certification) and the buyer's budget.
- for + duration, since + starting point (both with the present perfect) ; ago with the Past

Simple ; after + noun/gerund/clause ; afterwards stands alone.

- Key vocabulary : **bargain**, **discount**, **wholesale**, **retail**, **value for money**, **cost-effective**, **bulk purchase**.

3 BANKING SERVICES IN CAMEROON : READING & VOCABULARY

3.1 Transition from Smart Shopping to Banking Services

In the previous section, we learned how to **compare prices and quality** to make smart purchases as consumers. We used adverbs of time (for, since, ago) and comparison structures. Now, we move a step further : once you have earned money, you need a safe place to keep it and tools to make it grow. This is where **banking services** come in. In Cameroon, the landscape is evolving rapidly : traditional banks, microfinance institutions, and **mobile money** operators (Orange Money, MTN MoMo) all compete for customers. Understanding their offers, reading their contracts, and writing about them are essential skills for your professional life.

3.2 Authentic Reading : Bank Brochures & Key Vocabulary

Let us start by examining simplified extracts from real Cameroonian bank brochures (BICEC, Afriland First Bank, UBA, Ecobank). Read for gist first, then for detail.

EXEMPLE Brochure Extract : Opening a Compte Courant (Current Account)

BICEC – Bienvenue chez vous ! Open your current account in 3 steps :

1. Provide your KYC documents : valid ID (CNI/Passport), proof of address (utility bill less than 3 months old), two passport photos.
2. Visit any branch for signature and initial deposit (minimum 5000 FCFA).
3. Receive your debit card and cheque book within 48 hours.

Benefits : Free SMS alerts, online banking access, overdraft facility (subject to approval).

EXEMPLE Brochure Extract : Épargne Jeune / Youth Savings – Afriland First Bank

Start early, grow big ! Interest rate : 3,5% per annum (capitalised quarterly). Conditions : Age 18–35. No monthly fees. Minimum balance : 1000 FCFA. Mobile link : Link your account to Orange Money or MTN MoMo for instant deposits/withdrawals. Standing order : Set up automatic monthly transfers from your salary account.

DÉFINITION Financial Inclusion

Financial inclusion = accès effectif aux services financiers formels (compte, crédit, assurance, paiement) à coût abordable. Au Cameroun, le taux de bancarisation était d'environ 35% en 2023 (estimations BEAC/INS). La Stratégie Nationale d'Inclusion Financière (SNIF) 2023–2030 vise 65% d'adultes bancarisés.

English Term	French Gloss / Définition
Account opening	Ouverture de compte
Deposit / Withdrawal	Dépôt / Retrait
Interest rate	Taux d'intérêt (épargne ou crédit)
Loan / Credit	Prêt / Crédit
Collateral / Guarantee	Garantie (bien mis en gage)
Overdraft / Overdraft facility	Découvert (autorisé)
Standing order	Virement permanent (ordre permanent)
Bank statement	Relevé de compte
KYC (Know Your Customer)	Connaissance du client (procédure d'identification)
Financial inclusion	Inclusion financière
Mobile money	Monnaie mobile (Orange Money, MTN MoMo)
Microcredit	Microcrédit
Diaspora transfer / Remittance	Transfert de la diaspora
Account maintenance fees	Frais de tenue de compte
Borrower's insurance	Assurance emprunteur
Late payment penalty	Pénalité de retard
Usury rate / Cap rate	Taux d'usure (plafond légal)

3.3 Grammar Focus : Coordination – Building Complex Sentences

In professional writing (emails, reports, contracts), you must link ideas clearly. **Coordination** joins two independent clauses (complete sentences) of equal importance.

PROPRIÉTÉ Coordinating Conjunctions – FANBOYS

Use FANBOYS (For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So) to connect two independent clauses.

- And adds information : He opened an account and deposited money.
- But shows contrast : Rates are low, but the service is fast.
- Or gives an alternative : You can visit the branch or use the app.
- So shows result : She forgot her PIN, so she reset it.

Punctuation rule : Place a comma before the conjunction if both clauses have different subjects. If the subject is the same, no comma is needed.

PROPRIÉTÉ **Conjunctive Adverbs – However, Therefore, Moreover, Furthermore, Consequently**

These are not conjunctions. They connect two independent clauses with a semicolon (;) before and a comma (,) after.

Clause 1 ; however / therefore / moreover, Clause 2 .

- Interest rates are high ; however, microfinance helps small businesses.
- The KYC process is strict ; therefore, fraud is reduced.
- Mobile money is popular ; moreover, it reaches rural areas.

MÉTHODE **Coordonner deux propositions avec un adverbe de liaison**

Objectif : Écrire une phrase complexe correcte montrant contraste, conséquence ou addition.

1. Identifier les deux phrases indépendantes (sujet + verbe chacune).
2. Choisir l'adverbe selon la logique : however (contraste), therefore (conséquence), moreover (addition).
3. Ponctuer : point-virgule + adverbe + virgule.
4. Vérifier : chaque partie a son sujet et son verbe conjugué.

ATTENTION **Pièges fréquents**

- Confusion Interest rate vs Exchange rate : Interest rate = taux d'intérêt (épargne/crédit). Exchange rate = taux de change (devise). Ne pas confondre.
- Virgule manquante avec FANBOYS : He saved money, and he bought a car. (Sujets différents → virgule avant and.) He saved money and bought a car. (Même sujet → pas de virgule.)
- Point-virgule oublié : Rates are high, however microfinance helps. → Incorrect. Correct : Rates are high ; however, microfinance helps.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 3 Coordination Practice

Combine each pair into one sentence using the word in brackets. Punctuate correctly.

1. The bank approved the loan. The interest rate is 12%. (but)
2. You must provide your CNI. You must provide a proof of address. (and)
3. Mobile money is convenient. It has transaction limits. (however)
4. She forgot her password. She could not access her account. (so)

SOLUTION

Solutions :

1. The bank approved the loan, but the interest rate is 12%. (Two subjects → comma)
2. You must provide your CNI and a proof of address. (Same subject → no comma, ellipsis of the second subject.) Full form also correct : You must provide your CNI, and you must provide a proof of address.
3. Mobile money is convenient ; however, it has transaction limits. (Semicolon + comma)
4. She forgot her password, so she could not access her account. (Two subjects → comma)

3.4 Analysing Simplified Contract Clauses

Before signing, a smart consumer reads the **Terms & Conditions**. Here are key clauses to identify.

EXEMPLE Key Clauses in a Compte Épargne Contract – UBA Cameroon (Simplified)

1. Article 4 – Frais de tenue de compte : 1200 FCFA par trimestre (déduits automatiquement). Exonération si solde moyen mensuel > 50000 FCFA.
2. Article 7 – Taux d'intérêt (épargne) : 2,75% brut par an, capitalisé au 31/12. Prélèvement libératoire de 16,5% sur les intérêts.
3. Article 12 – Pénalités de retard (crédit) : En cas d'impayé, majoration de 2 points du taux nominal + frais de dossier 5000 FCFA.
4. Article 15 – Assurance emprunteur (obligatoire pour crédit > 500000 FCFA) : Prime de 0,5% du capital restant dû par an. Couvre décès et invalidité permanente.
5. Article 20 – Clôture : Préavis de 30 jours. Frais de clôture de 3000 FCFA si le compte a moins d'un an.

EXERCICE 4 Contract Analysis

Read the clauses above and answer in full sentences.

1. How much are the quarterly maintenance fees? When are they waived?
2. What is the net annual interest rate after the 16,5% tax on a 2,75% gross rate? (Calculate.)
3. If a borrower misses a payment on a loan at a 10% nominal rate, what is the new penalty rate?
4. Is borrower's insurance mandatory for a loan of 300000 FCFA? Why?

CORRIGÉ Exercice Contract Analysis

1. Quarterly fees are 1200 FCFA. They are waived if the average monthly balance exceeds 50000 FCFA.
2. Gross rate = 2,75%. Tax = 16,5% of the interest. Net rate = $2,75 \times (1 - 0,165) = 2,75 \times 0,835 \approx 2,30\%$.
3. Penalty rate = nominal rate + 2 points = 10% + 2% = 12% (plus 5000 FCFA fees).
4. No. Insurance is mandatory only for loans above 500000 FCFA. 300000 FCFA is below the threshold.

3.5 Case Study : Compte Jeune Entrepreneur – Comparing 3 Banks

You are a young technician starting a small business (e.g., welding, IT services, agri-processing). You need a professional account. Compare these simplified offers (2024 data).

Critère	BICEC – Jeune Pro	Afriland – Start'Up	UBA – Young Biz
Capital social minimum	100000 FCFA	50000 FCFA	100000 FCFA
Garanties exigées	Caution personnelle + domiciliation salaire	Caution solidaire (2 garants) ou nantissement matériel	Domiciliation chiffre d'affaires (min 200000/mois)
Délai d'ouverture	48 h (dossier complet)	24 h (digital onboarding)	72 h (validation risque)
Frais tenue compte / an	6000 FCFA (gratuits la 1 ^{re} année)	4800 FCFA	7200 FCFA
Plafond virement journalier	5000000 FCFA	3000000 FCFA	10000000 FCFA
Accès mobile money	Oui (Orange/MTN)	Oui (Orange/MTN + AfriMoney)	Oui (UBA Moni / Orange/MTN)
Microcrédit associé	Jusqu'à 5 M FCFA (taux 14%)	Jusqu'à 3 M FCFA (taux 12%)	Jusqu'à 10 M FCFA (taux 15%)

EXAMPLE Oral Interaction – Role Play

Student A (Client) : Ask about opening conditions, fees, mobile money link, loan access.
Student B (Bank Advisor) : Present your bank's offer using comparatives (lower than, higher than, the best) and coordination (moreover, however). Example : "Our fees are lower than BICEC's ; moreover, we open accounts in 24 hours. However, the daily transfer limit is lower."

3.6 Reading Comprehension : Banking in Cameroon (2023)

Read the text and answer the questions.

EXAMPLE Article : "Cameroun : la bancarisation stagne autour de 35%, le mobile money tire la croissance" – Adapted press article, 2023

Despite a dynamic microfinance sector and the explosion of mobile money (over 10 million active wallets), Cameroon's formal banking rate remains stuck around 35% of adults (estimates BEAC/INS 2023). The Littoral and Centre regions concentrate about 65% of bank branches, leaving the North and Far North severely underserved.

Commercial banks (BICEC, Afriland, UBA, Ecobank, SCB) hold the large majority of total deposits but serve mostly corporate clients and civil servants. Interest rate spreads (lending rate minus deposit rate) average 10–12 points, among the highest in the CEMAC zone, discouraging SME borrowing. The usury cap (taux d'usure) is set at 18% for consumer loans (BEAC regulation).

The National Financial Inclusion Strategy (SNIF) 2023–2030 targets 65% adult inclusion by 2030. Key levers : agent banking, digital onboarding (e-KYC), interoperability between banks and mobile money operators, and financial education in technical schools. Quote : "Mobile money is not a competitor ; it is a gateway. The future is hybrid," says a Cameroonian bank CEO.

EXERCICE 5 Reading Comprehension – MCQ & Open Questions

A. Multiple Choice (choose the best answer) :

1. According to the text, the banking rate in Cameroon in 2023 was approximately :
 - a) 18%
 - b) 35%
 - c) 65%
 - d) 85%
2. Which two regions concentrate about 65% of bank branches ?

- a) North & Far North
 - b) West & South-West
 - c) Littoral & Centre
 - d) East & Adamawa
3. What is the current usury cap (taux d'usure) for consumer loans in CEMAC ?
- a) 10%
 - b) 12%
 - c) 15%
 - d) 18%
4. The SNIF 2023–2030 targets 65% inclusion by 2030. Which is NOT a key lever mentioned?
- a) Agent banking
 - b) Digital onboarding (e-KYC)
 - c) Closing rural branches
 - d) Interoperability bank/Mobile Money
- B. Open Questions (answer in full sentences, use coordination) :
- 1. Explain why high interest rate spreads discourage SME borrowing. Use therefore or consequently.
 - 2. The CEO says "Mobile money is a gateway." What does he mean? Use moreover or furthermore to add a reason.
 - 3. Compare the banking situation in Littoral/Centre vs North/Far North. Use however or whereas.

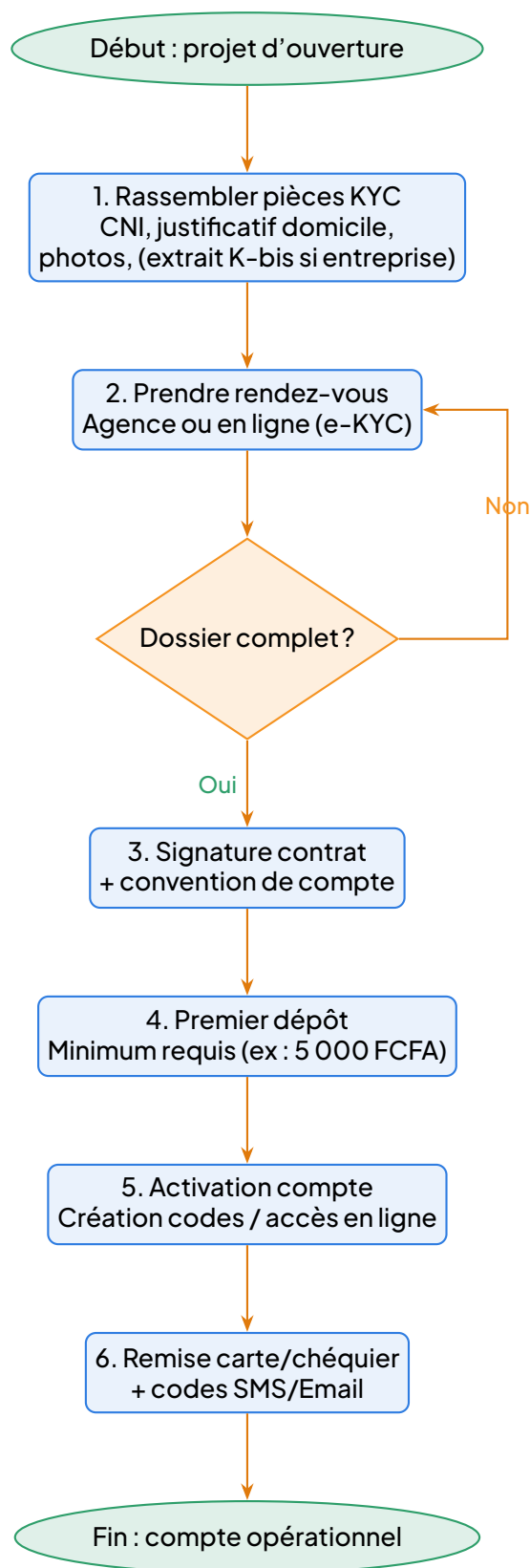
CORRIGÉ Exercice Reading Comprehension

A. MCQ : 1-b) 35% 2-c) Littoral & Centre 3-d) 18% 4-c) Closing rural branches

B. Open Questions (sample answers) :

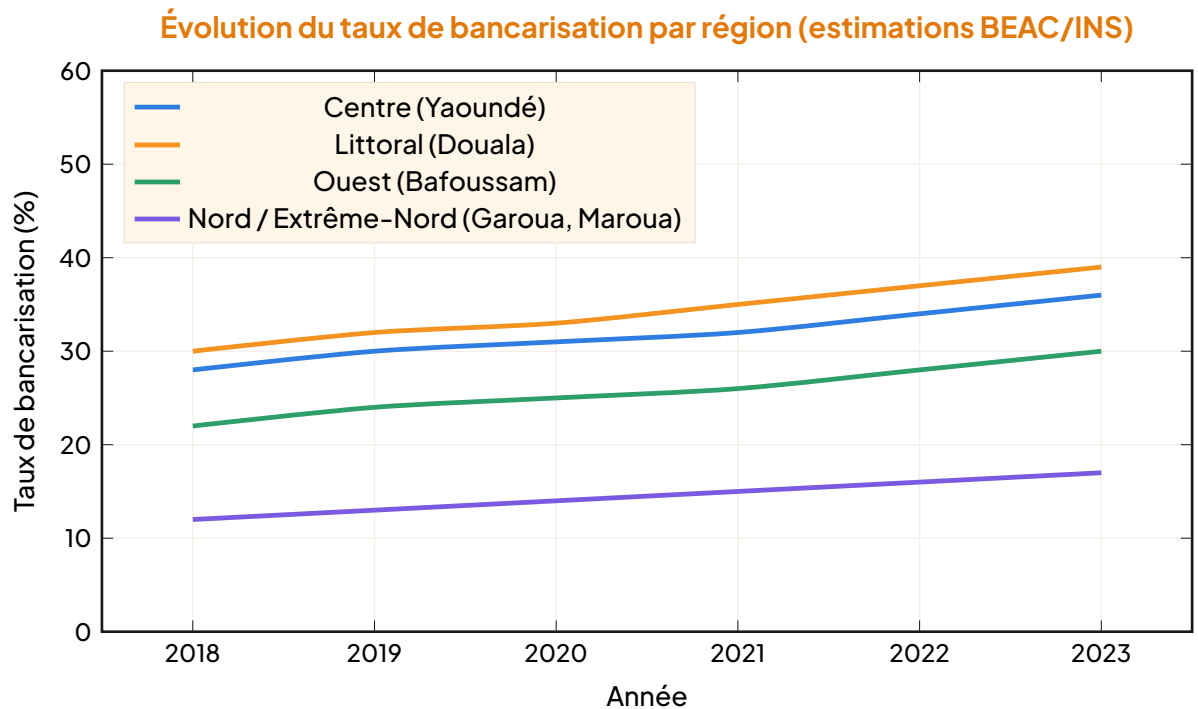
- 1. Interest rate spreads average 10–12 points ; therefore, the cost of credit is too high for small businesses to invest profitably.
- 2. He means mobile money brings unbanked people into the digital financial system ; moreover, it builds a transaction history that banks can later use to offer formal credit.
- 3. Littoral and Centre have about 65% of branches ; however, the North and Far North are severely underserved, whereas they have high mobile money adoption.

3.7 Illustration 1 : Flowchart – Account Opening Process in Cameroon



Processus standard d'ouverture de compte bancaire au Cameroun (basé sur les procédures BICEC/Afriland/UBA 2024). La boucle « Non » renvoie au rendez-vous pour compléter le dossier.

3.8 Illustration 2 : Banking Rate by Region (2018–2023) – pgfplots



Taux de bancarisation (adultes avec compte formel) par région, 2018–2023.
Source : estimations BEAC/INS (valeurs indicatives). Note : le Nord et l'Extrême-Nord restent très en retrait; le mobile money y comble partiellement l'écart.

3.9 Illustration 3 : Comparative Table – Fees, Savings Rates, Mobile Money Limits

Institution	Frais annuels (FCFA)	Taux épargne net (%/an)	Plafond Mobile Money (jour)
BICEC	6 000 (gratuits 1 ^{re} année)	2,3%	1 000 000 (Orange/MTN)
Afriland First Bank	4 800	2,5%	1 500 000 (AfriMoney + Orange/M
UBA Cameroon	7 200	2,0%	2 000 000 (UBA Moni + Orange/M
Ecobank	6 500	2,2%	1 000 000 (Ecobank Mobile + Orange
SCB Cameroun	5 500	2,4%	1 000 000 (Orange/MTN)
Orange Money	0 (frais par transaction)	0% (pas d'intérêt)	1 000 000 (retrait) / 5 000 000 (dé
MTN MoMo	0 (frais par transaction)	0% (pas d'intérêt)	1 000 000 (retrait) / 5 000 000 (dé

Comparatif simplifié 2024 : 5 banques commerciales + 2 opérateurs Mobile Money. Frais annuels = tenue de compte. Taux épargne net = après prélèvement libératoire de 16,5%. Plafonds Mobile Money = limites journalières réglementaires BEAC (valeurs indicatives).

3.10 Exemple Chiffré : Taux Directeur, Usure & Épargne

EXEMPLE Repères Chiffrés Clés 2024 (BEAC / Marché)

- Taux directeur BEAC (TIAO) : environ 5,00% (taux d'injection de liquidité).
- Taux d'usure (plafond légal crédits conso) : 18% (règlement CEMAC). Tout taux supérieur à 18% = usure (illégal).
- Taux crédit conso typique banques : 14–16% (sous le plafond).

- Taux crédit PME : 10–13% (selon garanties).
- Épargne livret (compte sur livret) : 2–3% net/an (après impôt de 16,5%).
- Épargne à terme (12 mois) : 4–5,5% brut (négociable au-delà de 10 M FCFA).
- Mobile Money : 0% d'intérêt (porte-monnaie électronique, pas un compte d'épargne).

3.11 Le Saviez-Vous ? – National Financial Inclusion Strategy

LESAVAIS-TU ? Stratégie Nationale d'Inclusion Financière (SNIF) 2023–2030

Le Cameroun a lancé en 2023 la SNIF avec l'appui de la BEAC et de la Banque Mondiale. Objectif : passer d'environ 35% (2023) à 65% d'adultes ayant accès à des services financiers formels d'ici 2030. Quatre piliers :

1. Accès : agent banking, e-KYC, interopérabilité Banque/Mobile Money.
2. Usage : paiement numérique des salaires, subventions, factures (Eneo, Camwater).
3. Qualité : protection du consommateur, éducation financière (dont dans l'enseignement technique).
4. Écosystème : fintech, crédit numérique, assurance indicielle agricole.

Impact pour vous : en Terminale technique, vous êtes la cible prioritaire de l'éducation financière. Maîtriser ces termes en anglais = atout professionnel majeur.

3.12 Integration Exercise : Writing a Formal Email to a Bank Advisor

EXERCICE 6 Writing Task – Formal Email

Context : You are a Terminale student in Maintenance Industrielle. You have saved 150 000 FCFA from holiday jobs. You want to open a Compte Épargne Jeune at Afriland First Bank. Write a formal email (120–150 words) to the bank advisor requesting an appointment. Use :

- At least 2 coordinating conjunctions (FANBOYS).
- At least 2 conjunctive adverbs (however, therefore, moreover) with correct punctuation (; ,).
- Key vocabulary : KYC, deposit, interest rate, standing order, mobile money link.

Structure : Subject line – Salutation – Purpose – Questions (fees, rate, mobile link, documents) – Proposed dates – Closing.

CORRIGÉ Exercice Writing Task – Sample Answer

Subject : Appointment Request – Youth Savings Account Opening (Compte Épargne Jeune)

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am a final-year technical student in Industrial Maintenance. I wish to open a Youth Savings Account at your Douala Akwa branch ; moreover, I would like to link it to my Orange Money wallet. I have saved 150,000 FCFA for the initial deposit.

Could you please confirm the current interest rate and the annual maintenance fees ? Furthermore, what KYC documents are required for a student ? I plan to set up a standing order of 10,000 FCFA monthly from my holiday job earnings.

I am available next Tuesday 14th or Thursday 16th after 3 pm. However, I can adapt to your schedule.

I look forward to your reply.

Yours faithfully,

Ngono Jean-Pierre

Tel : 6xx xx xx xx

Email : jp.ngono@email.com

3.13 Summary & Key Takeaways

À RETENIR Section 3 – Banking Services

- Vocabulary : Master the 15+ key terms (KYC, overdraft, standing order, collateral, usury rate, financial inclusion...).
- Reading : Identify key contract clauses (fees, interest, penalties, insurance, closure). Calculate net rates.
- Grammar – Coordination : FANBOYS (comma if different subjects). Conjunctive adverbs (however, therefore, moreover) → semicolon + adverb + comma.
- Case Study : Compare Jeune Entrepreneur offers : capital, guarantees, delay, fees, mobile link, microcredit access.
- Data : Banking rate around 35% (2023), target 65% (2030). Regional gaps (Centre/Littoral vs North/Far North). BEAC usury cap 18%.
- Writing : Formal email structure + coordination connectors for professional clarity.

4 COMPLEX SENTENCES : SUBORDINATION & EXPRESSING PREFERENCES

In the previous section (3. Banking Services in Cameroon), we read texts about opening accounts, applying for loans, and using mobile money. We noticed that professional banking documents rarely use simple, isolated sentences. Instead, they use **complex sentences** to show precise logical relationships : cause, condition, contrast, and time. Mastering **subordination** and **expressing preferences** will allow you to write formal emails, loan applications, and business reports that sound professional and convincing.

4.1 Understanding Subordination : Adverbial & Relative Clauses

DÉFINITION Subordination

Subordination is a grammatical link where a dependent clause (subordinate clause) cannot stand alone and adds information to a main clause (independent clause). The subordinate clause is introduced by a **subordinating conjunction** (e.g., because, although, if, when) or a **relative pronoun** (e.g., who, which, where, whose).

Main Clause + Subordinator + Subordinate Clause

Example (Banking context) : Because interest rates are high (Subordinate Clause of Cause), I prefer a savings account (Main Clause).

A. Adverbial Clauses (Propositions subordonnées circonstancielles)

These clauses function like adverbs : they answer Why?, When?, Under what condition?, Despite what?.

Function	Key Conjunctions	Banking Example
Cause / Reason	because, since, as	Since the TEG exceeds the usury rate, the contract is illegal.
Concession / Contrast	although, even though, while	Although the fees are high, the service is reliable.
Condition	if, unless (= if not), provided that	Unless you provide collateral, the bank will reject the loan.
Time	when, while, before, after, as soon as	As soon as you receive the SMS, confirm the transaction.

ATTENTION The “Although / But” Trap

Never use although / even though and but in the same sentence. They express the same logical relation (concession).

- Incorrect : Although the queue was long, but I waited.
- Correct : Although the queue was long, I waited. OR The queue was long, but I waited.

B. Relative Clauses (Propositions relatives)

These clauses modify a noun (the **antecedent**). They are introduced by relative pronouns : who (people), which (things), that (people or things, defining only), where (places), whose (possession).

PROPRIÉTÉ Defining vs. Non-Defining Relative Clauses

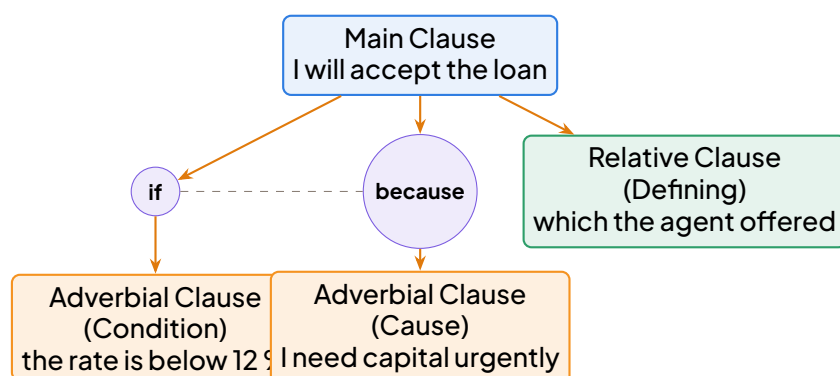
1. Defining (Restrictive) — No commas. Essential information. Identifies which one.

- The client who signed the cheque is waiting. (Which client ? The one who signed).
- This is the account which/that offers 5 % interest.

2. Non-Defining (Non-Restrictive) — Commas required. Extra, non-essential information.

- My bank manager, who knows me well, approved the loan instantly.
- The BEAC headquarters, which is in Yaoundé, regulates the usury rate.

Note : In non-defining clauses, you cannot use that ; you must use who/which.



Syntax Tree : Analysis of a complex banking sentence. Main Clause : “I will accept the loan”. 1. Adverbial Clause of Condition (if the rate is below 12 %). 2. Adverbial Clause of Cause (because I need capital urgently). 3. Defining Relative Clause (which the agent offered) modifying “the loan”.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 4 Combining Simple Sentences into Complex Ones

Task : Combine the following simple sentences into ONE complex sentence using the connector in brackets. Identify the type of subordinate clause created.

1. The microfinance institution charges 30 %. The commercial bank charges 14 %. (while / concession)
2. You want a mortgage. You must prove stable income. (if / condition)
3. The customer closed his account. The fees were too high. (because / cause)
4. The ATM swallowed my card. I entered the wrong PIN three times. (after / time)
5. The new agency opened in Douala. It offers Islamic banking. (which / relative)

SOLUTION

Solutions :

1. While the microfinance institution charges 30 %, the commercial bank charges 14 %. (Adverbial Clause of Concession/Contrast)
2. If you want a mortgage, you must prove stable income. (Adverbial Clause of Condition)
3. The customer closed his account because the fees were too high. (Adverbial Clause of Cause)
4. The ATM swallowed my card after I entered the wrong PIN three times. (Adverbial Clause of Time)
5. The new agency, which opened in Douala, offers Islamic banking. (Non-Defining Relative Clause — note the commas) OR The new agency which opened in Douala offers Islamic banking. (Defining — implies there are other agencies elsewhere).

4.2 Expressing Preferences & Strong Advice : Would Rather, Prefer, Had Better

In a professional banking context, you often need to advise a client or state your own choice clearly. Three structures are essential.

MÉTHODE Choosing the Right Structure for Preferences & Advice

Step 1 : Identify the Function.

- Specific Preference (Now/Future) : **Would rather / Would sooner** + Bare Infinitive (no to).
- General Preference (Habit/Taste) : **Prefer** + Gerund (-ing) or **Prefer** + Full Infinitive (to + V).

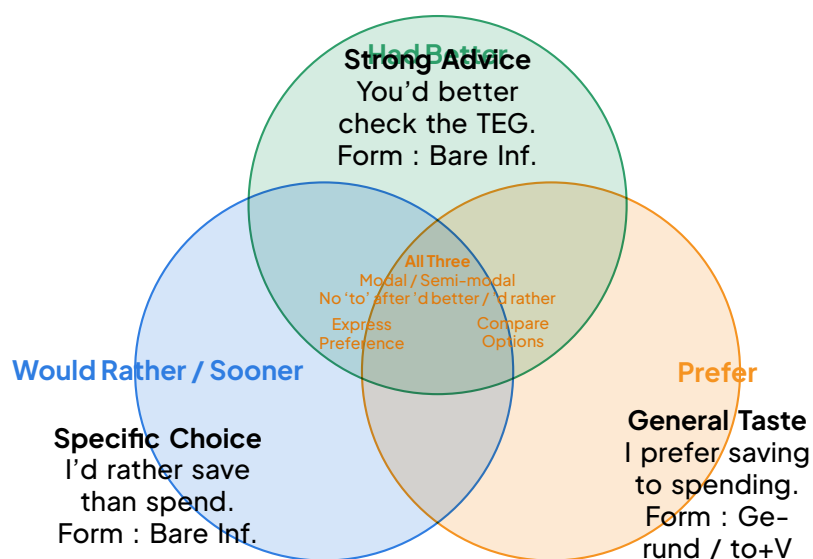
- Strong Advice / Warning (Consequence if ignored) : **Had better** + Bare Infinitive.

Step 2 : Check the Grammar Form.

Structure	Form	Negative	Time Reference
I'd rather	+ V (bare inf.)	I'd rather not V	Present / Future (Specific)
I prefer	+ V-ing / to V	I prefer not V-ing	General / Habitual
You'd better	+ V (bare inf.)	You'd better not V	Immediate Future (Warning)

Step 3 : Compare Alternatives (Comparison).

- I'd rather open a savings account than invest in stocks. (Comparing two specific actions now).
- I prefer saving to investing. (General habit, Gerund).
- I prefer to save rather than (to) invest. (Infinitive structure).



Venn Diagram : Comparison of Would Rather, Prefer, and Had Better. Central overlap : all express preference or advice and are followed by a verb form without 'to' (except prefer to V). Left : Specific/Immediate. Right : General/Habitual. Top : Warning/Consequence.

EXEMPLE Banking Context Examples

- Would rather (Specific) : "I'd rather keep my money in a term deposit than risk it on the stock market." (Decision for now).
- Prefer (General) : "Most Cameroonian SMEs prefer borrowing from microfinance to

waiting for bank approval.” (General observation).

- Had better (Warning) : “You’d better read the fine print before signing the loan agreement.” (Implied threat : otherwise you will lose money).

ATTENTION Common Errors with Preferences

1. Wrong : I’d rather to save. Right : I’d rather save. (Bare infinitive).
2. Wrong : I prefer save than spend. Right : I prefer saving to spending (Gerund) OR I prefer to save rather than (to) spend.
3. Wrong : You had better to go. Right : You’d better go. (Had is a past form but the meaning is present/future ; no to).
4. Contraction : Always use ’d in speech and informal writing : I’d rather, You’d better, He’d prefer.

LESAVAIS-TU ? La BEAC et le Taux d’Usure

La BEAC (Banque des États de l’Afrique Centrale), la banque centrale de la CEMAC dont le siège est à Yaoundé, encadre le taux d’usure (maximum legal interest rate), c’est-à-dire le taux maximal auquel une banque ou un établissement de microfinance peut prêter. Il est fixé par catégorie de crédit à partir du TEG (Taux Effectif Global) moyen pratiqué par les établissements, majoré d’une marge.

- Exemple chiffré (pédagogique) : Si le TEG moyen constaté pour les crédits aux PME est de 12 % et que la marge autorisée est d’un tiers, le taux d’usure = 12 % + 4 % = 16 %.
- Une banque qui prête à 18 % dans cette catégorie commet un délit d’usure. “Unless the rate respects the usury ceiling, the contract is void.”

4.3 Transformation Workshop : Informal Advice → Formal Recommendations

In professional writing (reports, official emails, loan proposals), we often transform direct, informal structures (You should, You must, I think) into **impersonal, passive, or subjunctive structures**. This is called **hedging** or using a **formal register**.

PROPRIÉTÉ Formal Transformation Patterns

Informal / Direct	Formal / Impersonal Structure	Example (Banking)
You should / must / have to	It is recommended / essential / mandatory that + Subjunctive (Base form)	It is mandatory that the borrower provide collateral.
I think / We believe	It is considered / believed / assumed that + Indicative	It is assumed that the rate will drop.
You need to	Requirement : + Noun phrase / Gerund	Providing a business plan is a requirement.
If you don't...	Failure to + V / Non-compliance with... results in...	Failure to repay results in legal action.

Note on the Subjunctive : After It is essential/vital/mandatory/recommended that, use the base form (no s, no to) for all persons. "It is essential that he sign (not signs) the cheque."

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 5 Rewriting Informal Advice into Formal Recommendations

Task : Rewrite the sentences using the formal structure indicated.

- Informal : "You should check your credit score before applying." → Formal (It is recommended that...)
- Informal : "You must repay the loan on time." → Formal (It is mandatory that...)
- Informal : "If you don't provide the documents, we will reject the file." → Formal (Failure to...)
- Informal : "I advise you to compare the TEG of different banks." → Formal (It is advisable to... / Comparing... is advisable)
- Informal : "The manager says you have to sign here." → Formal (The manager requires that...)

SOLUTION

Solutions :

- It is recommended that the applicant check his credit score before applying.
- It is mandatory that the borrower repay the loan on time.
- Failure to provide the documents will result in the rejection of the file.
- Comparing the TEG of different banks is advisable. OR It is advisable to compare the TEG...

5. The manager requires that the client sign here.

4.4 Practice Exercises

EXERCICE 7 Subordination & Connectors

A. Complete the sentences with the correct conjunction : although, unless, since, as soon as, while, provided that.

1. _____ the mobile money network is down, you cannot withdraw cash via USSD.
2. _____ the interest rate is variable, the monthly payment remains fixed for the first year.
3. You can get the preferential rate _____ you maintain a minimum balance of 500 000 FCFA.
4. _____ you receive the OTP (One Time Password), enter it immediately.
5. Microfinance is faster, _____ commercial banks offer lower rates.
6. _____ you have a guarantor, the microfinance institution won't lend you the money.

B. Join the pairs of sentences using a relative pronoun (who, which, where, whose). Add commas if necessary.

1. The teller helped me. She speaks English and French.
2. The branch is in Bonanjo. I opened my first account there.
3. The client missed the deadline. His file was incomplete.
4. The new ATM accepts Visa cards. It was installed yesterday.

EXERCICE 8 Preferences & Advice

C. Choose the correct form.

1. I'd rather (keep / keeping / to keep) my savings in FCFA than (convert / converting / to convert) to Euros right now.
2. Generally, customers (prefer / would rather) digital banking (to / than) queuing in the hall.
3. You'd better (to notify / notify / notifying) the bank immediately if you lose your card.
4. The director would sooner (resign / resigning / to resign) (than / to) approve an illegal loan.

D. Transform the following informal tips into formal banking recommendations (use It is... that, Failure to, Gerund subjects).

1. "Don't share your PIN with anyone."
2. "You must update your KYC (Know Your Customer) documents every year."
3. "If you miss a payment, your credit score drops."
4. "I suggest you use the bank's official app only."

CORRIGÉ Exercice 4.4

A. Conjunctions

1. Since / If the mobile money network is down, you cannot withdraw cash via USSD. (Cause / Condition)
2. Although the interest rate is variable, the monthly payment remains fixed for the first year. (Concession)
3. You can get the preferential rate provided that you maintain a minimum balance of 500 000 FCFA. (Condition)
4. As soon as you receive the OTP, enter it immediately. (Time)
5. Microfinance is faster, while commercial banks offer lower rates. (Contrast)
6. Unless you have a guarantor, the microfinance institution won't lend you the money. (Negative Condition)

B. Relative Clauses

1. The teller who helped me speaks English and French. (Defining — no commas)
2. The branch where I opened my first account is in Bonanjo. (Defining — no commas)
3. The client whose file was incomplete missed the deadline. (Defining — no commas)
4. The new ATM, which was installed yesterday, accepts Visa cards. (Non-defining — commas needed : extra information about the ATM).

C. Preferences & Advice

1. keep / convert (Would rather + bare infinitive ... than + bare infinitive)
2. prefer / to (General preference : Prefer + Gerund + to + Gerund)
3. notify (Had better + bare infinitive)
4. resign / than (Would sooner + bare infinitive ... than + bare infinitive)

D. Formal Transformations

1. Sharing your PIN with anyone is strictly prohibited. OR It is mandatory that clients not share their PIN.

2. It is mandatory that the client update KYC documents annually. OR Updating KYC documents annually is a requirement.
3. Failure to make a payment results in a drop in the credit score.
4. It is advisable that clients use only the bank's official app. OR Using the bank's official app is strongly recommended.

À RETENIR Key Takeaways for Section 4

- Subordination creates hierarchy : Main Idea (Main Clause) + Supporting Detail (Subordinate Clause).
- Adverbial Clauses : Cause (because/since), Concession (although), Condition (if/unless/provided that), Time (when/before/after/as soon as).
- Relative Clauses : Defining (no commas, identifies) vs Non-defining (commas, extra information). Never use that in non-defining clauses.
- Preferences : Would rather + V (specific, now) vs Prefer + V-ing/to V (general). Comparison : rather... than, prefer... to.
- Strong Advice : Had better + V (warning of a bad consequence).
- Formal Writing : Transform You must/should → It is mandatory/recommended that + Subjunctive (Base Verb).

5 WRITING WORKSHOP : COMPOSING ABOUT BANKING SERVICES

Building on the complex sentences and preference structures mastered in Section 4, we now move from sentence-level accuracy to text-level coherence. In professional banking contexts, a single grammatical error or a poorly structured paragraph can lead to a rejected loan application or an unresolved complaint. This workshop teaches you to craft complete, purpose-driven texts – formal letters, complaint emails, analytical reports, and blog articles – that meet the standards of Cameroonian financial institutions and the expectations of the Probatoire/Baccalauréat technique examination.

5.1 Analysing Model Texts : Formal Banking Correspondence

Before writing, we must read like writers. Professional banking communication in Cameroon follows strict conventions : a formal tone, precise vocabulary, logical organisation, and a clear **call to action**. Let us dissect the anatomy of a formal banking letter.

DÉFINITION Call to Action

A call to action (CTA) is the final sentence of a formal letter or email that states exactly what you expect the recipient to do. It removes ambiguity and prompts a response.

- Weak : I hope you will help me.
- Strong : I kindly request that you schedule a meeting within the next ten working days to discuss the revision of my account maintenance fees.

STRUCTURE

1. SENDER'S ADDRESS (Top Right)

Your Name / Business Name

P.O. Box 1234, Yaoundé, Cameroon

Tel : (+237) 6XX XX XX XX | Email : name@email.cm

2. DATE (Below Sender, Right)

Yaoundé, 15 October 2025

3. RECIPIENT'S ADDRESS (Left)

The Branch Manager

Afriland First Bank, Bastos Branch

P.O. Box 6789, Yaoundé

4. OBJET / SUBJECT LINE (Bold, Centred)**REQUEST FOR REDUCTION OF ACCOUNT MAINTENANCE FEES**

Account No : 10002-0345678-98

5. SALUTATION

Dear Sir / Madam, (never "Dear Friend" or "Hi")

BODY :

6. PARAGRAPH 1 : CONTEXT & PURPOSE

I am writing as a loyal customer of 5 years (Account #10002-0345678-98) to formally request a review of the quarterly maintenance fees currently charged at 6,250 FCFA.

7. PARAGRAPH 2 : ARGUMENTATION (FACTS + COMPARISON)

Comparing your fee structure with competitors (e.g., UBA : 4,500 FCFA; BI-CEC : 5,000 FCFA), I find the current rate 25% above the market average. Given my average monthly turnover of 2,000,000 FCFA and zero overdraft history, I believe a reduction is justified.

8. PARAGRAPH 3 : PREFERENCE + CALL TO ACTION

I would rather maintain my relationship with Afriland First Bank than switch providers. I kindly request a reduction to 4,500 FCFA per quarter and propose a meeting next week to finalise the amendment.

9. FORMAL CLOSING (Long Formula)

I look forward to your favourable response.

Yours faithfully,

(Signature)

John N. Doe

END :

Four Model Text Types for the Exam.

You must recognise and reproduce the distinct register and structure of each :

Model Type	Purpose	Key Vocabulary	Grammar Focus
Formal Loan Request Letter	Persuade bank to grant credit	collateral (garantie), repayment schedule (échéancier), interest rate (taux d'intérêt), feasibility study (étude de faisabilité), cash flow (flux de trésorerie)	Subordination (provided that, on condition that), Passive (It is requested that...)
Complaint Email (Undue Fees)	Obtain refund / correction	discrepancy (écart), unauthorized debit (prélèvement non autorisé), statement (relevé), refund (remboursement), investigate (enquêter)	Coordination (not only... but also), Adverbs of time (recently, subsequently, previously)
Bank Product Evaluation Report	Compare & recommend	pros/cons (avantages/inconvénients), benchmarking, yield (rendement), liquidity (liquidité), risk profile (profil de risque)	Double comparison (factors), higher..., the lower..., Equality (as competitive as)
Blog Article : "Choosing a Bank in Cameroon"	Inform / Guide peers	mobile money (Mobile Money), branch network (réseau d'agences), digital banking (banque en ligne), KYC	Expressing preferences (I would recommend, It is advisable to), Imperatives for advice

EXEMPLE Analysing a Complaint Email – Structure Breakdown

Subject : Dispute Regarding Unauthorised SMS Alert Charges – Acct 10002–0345678–98

Dear Customer Service Manager,

(Context) I am writing to dispute a charge of 500 FCFA for “SMS Alert Services” debited on 03/10/2025. I never subscribed to this service.

(Evidence) My contract (Clause 4.2) states : “Optional services require explicit written consent.” My signed contract has no tick-box for SMS alerts. Furthermore, the charge appears neither on my initial fee schedule nor on the tariff guide displayed in the branch.

(Action) I request an immediate refund of 500 FCFA and the permanent deactivation of this service. I have attached a screenshot of the debit and the relevant contract page.

(Closing) I expect a resolution within 5 working days.

Yours faithfully,
Marie K.

5.2 The Standard Structure of a Banking Composition

Every high-scoring composition – whether a letter, report, or essay – follows a macro-structure that guides the reader logically from context to action.

PROPRIÉTÉ Cohésion Lexicale – Lexical Chains

Cohésion lexicale is the use of semantically related words across paragraphs to create texture and flow. In banking texts, activate the Banking Lexical Chain :

bank → account → deposit → interest → loan → repayment → credit score → collateral

Rule : Do not repeat “bank” ten times. Use the institution, the lender, the branch, the financial partner. Do not repeat “money”. Use funds, capital, liquidity, balance, turnover.

MÉTHODE Planifier avant d’écrire – 5 Steps to a Band 20/20

1. Analyser le sujet (Public, But, Ton). Ex : “Lettre à la banque pour négocier des frais” → Public = Directeur d’agence (formel), But = Négociateur (persuasif), Ton = Respectueux mais ferme.
2. Brainstormer arguments + vocabulaire clé. Créez deux colonnes : Arguments POUR (ancienneté, volume transactions, fidélité) et Vocabulaire bancaire (tenue de compte, commission, découvert, échéancier).
3. Structurer en paragraphes (1 idée = 1 paragraphe). Paragraphe 1 : Contexte. Paragraphe 2 : Argument 1 (comparaison). Paragraphe 3 : Argument 2 (historique client).

Paragraphe 4 : Préférence + Call to Action.

4. Rédiger le brouillon. Écrivez sans vous arrêter. Utilisez les connecteurs préparés (furthermore, however, consequently, provided that).
5. Relire (Checklist 5 minutes). [≡] Objet clair? [≡] Salutation/Clôture correctes? [≡] 0 contraction (I'm → I am)? [≡] Au moins 2 phrases complexes (subordination)? [≡] Vocabulaire technique (5+ termes)? [≡] Call to action précis?

ATTENTION Formal Register Traps – Automatic Mark Deductions

In formal banking writing, the following are penalised at the Bac Technique :

- Contractions : I'm, don't, can't, won't, it's → Always write : I am, do not, cannot, will not, it is.
- Abbreviations : etc., e.g., i.e., approx., info → Write out : and so on, for example, that is, approximately, information.
- Colloquialisms : kids, guys, cool, okay, a lot of, get → Use : children, colleagues, satisfactory, acceptable, a significant number of, obtain/receive.
- Active voice for objectivity : Prefer It is requested that the fees be revised over I want you to revise the fees.
- “Although...but” error : **Although I am a loyal customer, but I am unhappy.** → **Although I am a loyal customer, I am unhappy.** OR **I am a loyal customer, but I am unhappy.** (Never both connectors).

5.3 Writing Practice : Two Examination Topics

You will choose **ONE** topic. Both require 250–300 words, formal register, banking vocabulary, and complex sentences (coordination + subordination).

EXEMPLE Données comparatives réelles – Cameroun 2024/2025

Utilisez ces chiffres concrets pour étayer vos arguments (sources : sites web banques, MINCOMMERCE, GIMAC).

Frais / Service	Compte Bancaire Classique (Moyenne 3 banques)	Mobile Money (Orange Money / MTN MoMo)
Ouverture de compte	5 000 – 10 000 FCFA (souvent offert si dépôt initial)	0 FCFA (gratuite, carte d'identité seulement)
Frais de tenue de compte (annuel)	12 000 – 25 000 FCFA	0 FCFA
Retrait au guichet / agent	Gratuit (propre banque) / 1 000–2 000 FCFA (autre)	1% – 2% du montant (min 50 FCFA, max 10 000 FCFA)
Virement interne	500 – 1500 FCFA	Gratuit (même opérateur)
Virement interbancaire / inter-opérateur	2 000 – 5 000 FCFA + délai 24–48h	100 – 500 FCFA (instantané)
Plafond journalier retrait	Selon convention (souvent 500 000 – 1 000 000 FCFA)	500 000 FCFA (Orange) / 1 000 000 FCFA (MTN)
Accès au crédit	Oui (prêt, découvert, leasing) – nécessite historique	Limité (nano-crédit : 5 000–500 000 FCFA, court terme)
Sécurité / Assurance dépôts	Couvert par le Fonds de Garantie (jusqu'à 50 MFCFA)	Non couvert par fonds de garantie bancaire

Calcul sur 5 ans (exemple) : Tenue compte 18 000 FCFA/an $\times$ 5 = 90 000 FCFA. Mobile Money : 0 FCFA frais fixes, mais si 2 retraits/mois de 50 000 FCFA $\times$ 1,5% $\times$ 60 mois = 90 000 FCFA frais variables. Le point d'équilibre dépend de votre volume de retraits.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 6**Sujet 1 : “Avantages et inconvénients du Mobile Money vs Compte bancaire classique pour un jeune entrepreneur camerounais”**

Plan détaillé + Introduction & Conclusion modèles.

Title : Mobile Money vs Traditional Bank Account : A Strategic Choice for Young Cameroonian Entrepreneurs

Introduction (40 mots) : In Cameroon's dynamic digital economy, young entrepreneurs face a critical financial decision : relying solely on Mobile Money services like Orange Mo-

ney or MTN MoMo, or opening a traditional bank account. While both offer transactional capabilities, they serve distinct strategic needs. This essay compares their respective advantages and limitations to guide an informed choice.

Body Paragraph 1 : Accessibility & Costs (70 mots) : Mobile Money excels in accessibility. Opening an account requires only a national ID card and a phone number, with zero opening fees and no maintenance charges. For a startup with irregular cash flow, this eliminates the 12 000–25 000 FCFA annual fees typical of banks (UBA, Afriland, BICEC). However, withdrawal fees of 1–2% accumulate rapidly; an entrepreneur withdrawing 500 000 FCFA monthly pays 7 500–15 000 FCFA monthly – exceeding annual bank fees.

Body Paragraph 2 : Credit Access & Business Growth (70 mots) : Conversely, a traditional bank account builds a credit history – the gateway to business loans, overdraft facilities, and leasing. Banks require 6–12 months of statements to assess repayment capacity. Mobile Money offers only nano-credits (up to 500 000 FCFA) at high daily rates, insufficient for equipment purchase or stock financing. Provided that the entrepreneur maintains clean statements, the bank becomes a growth partner, not just a custodian.

Body Paragraph 3 : Security & Professional Image (50 mots) : Bank deposits are insured up to 50 million FCFA by the Deposit Guarantee Fund (Fonds de Garantie des Dépôts), whereas Mobile Money balances lack this protection. Moreover, a corporate bank account (compte professionnel) enhances credibility with suppliers and institutional clients who often reject Mobile Money numbers for B2B payments.

Conclusion + Recommendation (40 mots) : In conclusion, Mobile Money is ideal for daily micro-transactions and financial inclusion, but a traditional account is indispensable for scaling. I would strongly advise a hybrid strategy : use Mobile Money for retail collections and the bank account for savings, supplier payments, and credit building.

Total : ≈ 270 mots. Grammar highlights : While both offer... (subordination), However / Conversely (coordination/adverbials), Provided that (condition), I would strongly advise (preference), ideal for / indispensable for (prepositional collocations).

SOLUTION

Solution détaillée : Ce modèle montre la structure attendue : introduction avec thèse, trois paragraphes de développement (accès/coûts, crédit/croissance, sécurité/image), conclusion avec recommandation claire. Le vocabulaire bancaire est précis (turnover, overdraft, credit history, nano-credits, deposit guarantee fund). Les connecteurs variés assurent la cohésion. Les structures complexes incluent la subordination (While, Provided that), la coordination (However, Conversely), l'expression de préférence (I would strongly advise).

EXERCICE 9 Sujet 2 – À vous de jouer !

Rédigez la lettre formelle complète (250–300 mots). Sujet : “Vous êtes titulaire d'un compte courant à la Société Générale Cameroun depuis 3 ans. Votre chiffre d'affaires

mensuel moyen est de 1 500 000 FCFA. Vous jugez les frais de tenue de compte (22 000 FCFA/trimestre) excessifs par rapport à la concurrence. Écrivez au Directeur d'Agence pour négocier une baisse à 12 000 FCFA/trimestre."

Contraintes obligatoires :

1. Structure complète (En-tête, Objet, 3 paragraphes corps, Call to action, Formule longue, Pièces jointes).
2. Minimum 5 termes de vocabulaire bancaire (surlignez-les).
3. Minimum 2 phrases de subordination (although, provided that, on condition that, in order that).
4. Minimum 2 connecteurs de coordination (not only... but also, furthermore, consequently).
5. Zéro contraction, zéro abréviation, zéro langage familier.

5.4 Self-Assessment Grid & Peer Review

Autonomous learners evaluate their own work before the teacher does. Use this radar chart criteria – each axis scored 0–4 (total 20).

Critère	Score (0–4)
Content / Relevance	... /4
Organisation & Connectors	... /4
Banking Vocabulary	... /4
Complex Grammar	... /4
Spelling & Mechanics	... /4

Scoring Guide (0–4 each) : 4 = Excellent; 3 = Good; 2 = Fair; 1 = Weak; 0 = Absent. **Total /20** = somme des 5 critères.

Grille d'auto-évaluation (5 critères × 4 points = 20).

Critère	Indicateurs de réussite (Score 4/4)
Content Relevance	All prompt requirements addressed ; arguments are specific, quantified (using data from §5.3), and logically developed ; clear stance/preference expressed.
Organisation & Connectors	4–5 distinct paragraphs (1 idea each) ; logical flow (Context → Arguments → CTA) ; varied connectors (furthermore, however, consequently, provided that, in addition) ; no “and/but/so” only.
Banking Vocabulary	8+ precise terms used correctly (maintenance fees, overdraft, collateral, repayment schedule, creditworthiness, KYC, turnover, discrepancy, refund, statement). No vague words (money, paper, thing).
Complex Grammar	3+ complex sentences : at least 1 subordination (although, provided that, in order that), 1 coordination (not only... but also), 1 preference structure (would rather, would prefer, it is advisable that). Passive used for objectivity.
Spelling & Mechanics	Zero contractions, zero abbreviations, correct formal salutations/closings, accurate punctuation, consistent British/UK spelling (cheque, programme, organise).

5.5 Guided Rewriting : Improving Cohesion & Variety

Writing is rewriting. The gap between a “passable” (10/20) and an “excellent” (18+/20) text is almost always **cohesion** (flow) and **syntactic variety**. Let us transform a typical student draft.

Original Draft (Student)

Dear Sir,
 I write this letter because I want to complain about fees. My account number is 10002-034. I am a customer since 3 years. The fees are too high. Other banks are cheaper. I want you to reduce them. If you don't reduce, I will close my account. I hope you answer me.
 Yours faithfully,
 Paul

Commentaires enseignant :

- × "I write this letter because" → trop oral. **Use** : I am writing to formally request...
- × "I am a customer since 3 years" → erreur grammaire (since + point de départ). **Use** : I have been a customer **for** 3 years / **since** 2022.
- × "Other banks are cheaper" → vague. **Use** : Competitor analysis shows UBA charges 4,500 FCFA vs your 6,250 FCFA.
- × "If you don't reduce..." → menace, condition mal formulée. **Use** : Unless a revision is granted, I **will be compelled to** transfer my account.
- × "I hope you answer me" → pas de Call to Action. **Use** : I **look forward to your written response within 10 working days**.

Rewritten Version (Target 18+/20)

Dear Sir,
 I am writing to formally request a review of the quarterly maintenance fees applied to my current account (No. 10002-034), which I have held for three years.
Not only does my average monthly turnover reach 1,800,000 FCFA, **but** I have also never used an overdraft facility. **However**, a benchmarking of three major banks reveals your fee of 6,250 FCFA/quarter exceeds the market average of 4,800 FCFA by 30%.
Provided that you agree to align your tariff to 4,500 FCFA/quarter, I **would rather** maintain my relationship with your institution than switch providers. **Otherwise**, I **will be compelled to** transfer my domiciliation.
 I **kindly request a meeting next week to finalise this amendment** and look forward to your written confirmation within ten working days.
 Yours faithfully,
 Paul M.
 Enc. : Fee comparison table (3 banks), Last 6 months statements

Processus de réécriture guidée : texte original → commentaires ciblés (grammaire, vocabulaire, registre, cohésion) → version améliorée. Notez l'intégration de not only... but also, however, provided that, would rather, otherwise, compelled to.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 7**Exercice de réécriture – Appliquez la méthode**

Consigne : Réécrivez le paragraphe suivant en améliorant : (1) la cohésion lexicale (chaînes bancaires), (2) la variété syntaxique (subordination + coordination), (3) le registre formel.
 Texte élève : “Banks are important for business. They give loans. You need a good account. If you have a good account, the bank gives you money. But fees are high. I think banks should lower fees. Because small businesses don’t have much money. Also mobile money is cheaper. But mobile money doesn’t give big loans. So you need both. I prefer bank for big things and mobile money for small things.”

Version révisée (modèle) : “Financial institutions play a pivotal role in enterprise development by providing credit facilities tailored to cash flow cycles. Provided that a business maintains a healthy account history – characterised by consistent turnover and zero default – it unlocks access to working capital loans and overdraft facilities. Nevertheless, exorbitant maintenance fees (often 20,000+ FCFA/quarter) disproportionately burden micro-enterprises. While Mobile Money offers cost-effective transactionality for retail collections, it lacks the capacity for long-term asset financing. Consequently, a dual-channel strategy – leveraging Mobile Money for liquidity management and a traditional account for creditworthiness building – is advisable.”

Analyse des améliorations :

- Cohésion lexicale : financial institutions → credit facilities → cash flow → account history → turnover → default → working capital → overdraft → maintenance fees → micro-enterprises → transactionality → asset financing → dual-channel → liquidity management → creditworthiness. (17 maillons!)
- Syntaxe : Provided that... (subordination conditionnelle), While... (concession), Consequently... (conséquence), Passive : is advisable.
- Registre : Zéro contraction, vocabulaire précis (pivotal, disproportionately, exorbitant, retail collections, asset financing).

SOLUTION

Solution détaillée : La révision transforme un texte élémentaire (phrases courtes, vocabulaire vague, répétitions) en un texte académique cohérent. La chaîne lexicale bancaire crée la cohésion. Les subordonnées (Provided that, While) et les connecteurs (Nevertheless, Consequently) structurent l’argumentation. Le registre formel élimine les contractions et utilise le passif pour l’objectivité.

5.6 Publication & Real-World Application

The ultimate test of a banking text is its effect in the real world. The Cameroonian legal framework empowers you to use these writing skills concretely.

LESAVAIS-TU ? Vos droits réels – Loi camerounaise

La Loi n°2011/012 du 6 mai 2011 (Code de la Consommation), en son Article 17, interdit les clauses abusives dans les contrats bancaires (frais disproportionnés, modification unilatérale sans préavis, renonciation aux recours). L'Article 42 vous donne le droit de saisir la Commission Nationale de la Consommation (CNC) auprès du MINCOMMERCE pour tout litige non résolu par la banque en 30 jours. Application pratique : Votre lettre de réclamation (Sujet 2, §5.3) n'est pas un exercice scolaire – c'est une mise en demeure juridique. Conservez une copie signée + accusé de réception. Si pas de réponse sous 30 jours → Saisine MINCOMMERCE (gratuit). C'est ce pouvoir réel qui donne du sens à votre apprentissage de l'anglais bancaire formel.

EXERCICE 10 Tâche finale intégrée – Portfolio Exam Ready

Choisissez UNE des trois options et produisez une version finale « prête à envoyer / publier ».

1. Option A (Lettre réelle) : Finalisez votre lettre de négociation de frais (Sujet 2, §5.3) après réécriture (§5.5). Imprimez-la, signez-la, mettez-la sous enveloppe avec pièces jointes simulées. Remettez au professeur pour évaluation sommative (sur 20 avec grille radar).
2. Option B (Article de blog) : Rédigez l'article "How to Choose Your Bank in Cameroon : A 2025 Guide for Tech Students" (300–350 mots). Cible : vos camarades de Terminale. Ton : informel mais vocabulaire technique précis. Publiez sur le blog de classe / groupe WhatsApp de la section.
3. Option C (Rapport d'évaluation) : En binôme, comparez deux offres réelles de « Compte Jeune Entrepreneur » (ex : Afriland Jeune Pro vs UBA NextGen vs BICEC Start). Produisez un rapport structuré (Intro, Tableau comparatif, Analyse coûts/bénéfices sur 3 ans, Recommandation conditionnelle "If X, then Y ; provided that Z"). Présentez oralement 3 min (évaluation Speaking).

Critères communs : Grille radar (§5.4) $\geq 16/20$ + zéro faute « Attention » (§5.2) + Call to action explicite.

CORRIGÉ Exercice Sujet 2 – Lettre de négociation (Modèle de référence)

Yaoundé, 15 October 2025
 The Branch Manager
 Société Générale Cameroun, Akwa Branch
 P.O. Box 123, Douala

OBJET : REQUEST FOR REDUCTION OF QUARTERLY ACCOUNT MAINTENANCE FEES

Account No : 10002-0345678-98

Dear Sir,

I am writing as a loyal corporate client of three years (Account No. 10002-0345678-98) to formally request a revision of the quarterly maintenance fees currently charged at 22,000 FCFA.

Not only does my account record an average monthly turnover of 1,500,000 FCFA, but I have also maintained a clean history with zero overdraft incidents and full KYC compliance. However, a comparative benchmarking of three major banks in Douala reveals that your fee exceeds the market average of 14,000 FCFA by 57%. For instance, UBA charges 12,000 FCFA and BICEC 13,500 FCFA for equivalent service packages.

Provided that you agree to align the quarterly fee to 12,000 FCFA – reflecting my volume and loyalty – I would strongly prefer to consolidate my banking relationship with Société Générale rather than migrate to a competitor. Otherwise, I will be compelled to initiate account closure procedures.

I kindly request a meeting within the next ten working days to formalise this amendment and look forward to your favourable written response.

Yours faithfully,

(Signature)

Jean-Pierre M.

General Manager, JPM Agro-Services SARL

Enc. : 1) Bank statements (Jan-Jun 2025) 2) Fee comparison table (3 banks) 3) Business registration (Extrait K-bis)

Word count : 268. Grammar : Subordination (Provided that), Coordination (Not only... but also, However), Preference (would strongly prefer), Passive (be compelled to), Zero contractions/abbreviations. Vocabulary : 12+ banking terms.

Teacher's Note : This Writing Workshop completes the Economic Life and Occupations unit. The integration activity (Section 6) will combine **Listening** (price comparison audio), **Speaking** (role-play bank appointment), **Reading** (bank contract analysis), and this **Writing** portfolio in a single simulated "Financial Literacy Day" assessment. Prepare your portfolio (letter + essay + self-assessment grid) for submission.

6

INTEGRATION, EVALUATION & REMEDIATION

In the previous sections, you practised assessing consumer needs, comparing prices and quality, mastering banking vocabulary, building complex sentences (coordination and subordination), expressing preferences, and writing compositions about banking services. Now it is time to bring everything together. In this final section, you will use all the skills of the lesson in one realistic project. Then you will be evaluated, evaluate yourself, and receive targeted remediation.

tion where needed. This is exactly the spirit of the **integration activities** of the official programme.

DÉFINITION What is integration ?

Integration is the joint mobilisation of knowledge (savoirs), know-how (savoir-faire) and attitudes (savoir-être) in a new, complex situation close to real professional life. It is not a simple revision exercise : you must transfer what you learned in Sections 1 to 5 to solve an authentic problem you have never seen before.

6.1 Integrative Project : A Simplified Business Plan for a Village Cooperative

The situation. Your village (or your school neighbourhood) wants to create a small **cooperative** (une coopérative) to buy food products in bulk and resell them at fair prices to members. Your class, divided into teams of four, must produce a **simplified business plan in English** and defend it orally in front of a “banker” (your teacher).

The project naturally recycles every skill of the lesson :

- **Section 1 — Assessing needs** : design a short questionnaire and survey 10 potential members about their consumer needs and the community resources available.
- **Section 2 — Smart shopping** : compare prices and quality of three suppliers to find the **best buy** for bulk purchases (achats groupés).
- **Section 3 — Banking services** : choose a bank or microfinance institution (institution de microfinance), compare **interest rates**, **account fees** and **loan conditions**, and justify your choice.
- **Sections 4–5 — Argumentation and writing** : write a one-page report using complex sentences (coordination, subordination) and expressions of preference (We would rather open a savings account because...).

MÉTHODE The project approach — démarche projet

Follow these five steps, in order :

1. Define the real problem. What do people in the community need? What is missing? Write one clear problem sentence : “Families in our quarter pay too much for rice and soap.”
2. Plan tasks and roles. In each team, appoint a **surveyor**, a **price analyst**, a **banking researcher** and a **writer/presenter**. Every member speaks during the final defence.
3. Collect information. Use fieldwork (interviews, market visits) and the internet (bank websites, price lists). Record data in tables.
4. Produce the deliverables. A written report (250–300 words) with a comparison table, and a 5-minute oral presentation.

5. Present and defend. Answer the “banker’s” questions using comparatives, adverbs of time (for, since, ago) and preference structures.



Gantt chart of the integrative project over three weeks (15 working days). Bars show task duration and overlap. Diamonds mark the three deliverables : survey report, written draft, final oral defence.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 8

Sample extract from a team's report

Task : write the “banking choice” paragraph of the business plan (about 80 words), using at least one comparative, one adverb of time and one expression of preference.

SOLUTION

Model answer : “We have compared three banks for two weeks. Bank A offers lower account fees than Bank B, but its interest rate on loans is twice as high as Bank C’s. Since January, Bank C has also provided free mobile banking, which is useful in our village. We would rather open our account at Bank C because it is cheaper and closer to our members.”

Why it works : comparative of inferiority/superiority (lower... than), double comparison (twice as high as), adverbs of time (for, since), coordination (but, because), subordination (which), preference (would rather). All the grammar targets of the lesson appear naturally.

6.2 Formative Evaluation

Evaluation here is **formative** : its goal is to show you what you master and what you must still improve before the exam.

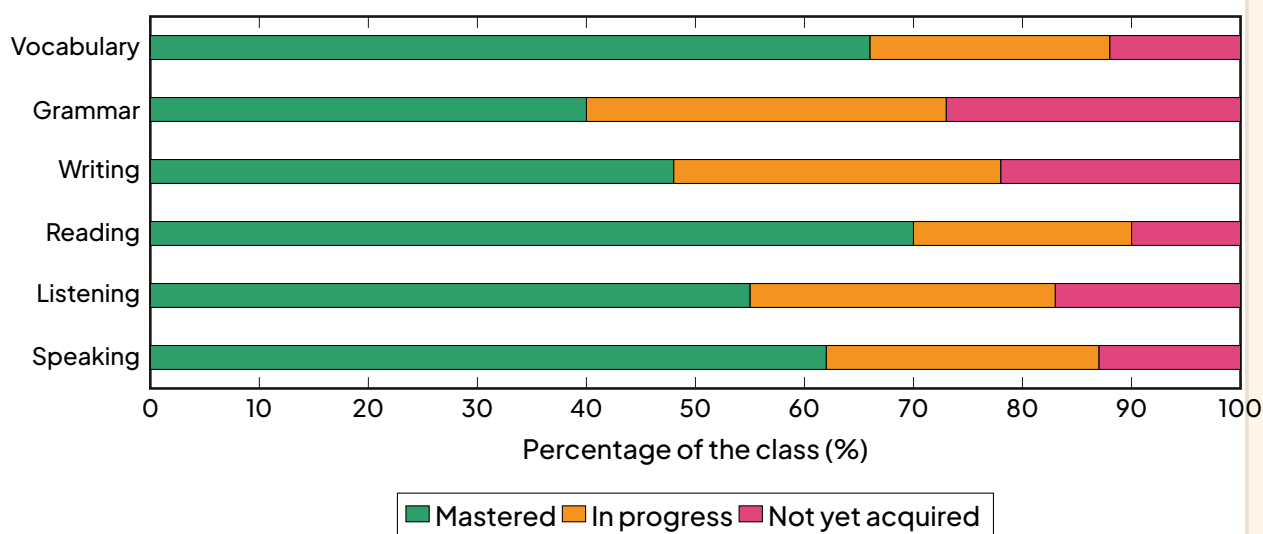
Activity 1 — Digital quiz (Kahoot/Quizizz, 15 min). Twenty questions on the vocabulary of banking and consumption (loan, overdraft, discount, value for money...) and on grammar (comparisons of equality and degree, adverbs for/since/ago, coordination vs subordination). Instant feedback allows immediate correction of misconceptions.

Activity 2 — Assessed role-play : negotiating a loan. In pairs, one student is the **loan applicant**, the other the **bank manager**. The applicant must explain the cooperative's needs, compare two offers and express a preference; the manager asks questions about guarantees and repayment. Assessment criteria : fluency (2 pts), correct grammar in context (2 pts), appropriate vocabulary (1 pt).

Activity 3 — Marked written production. A 250-word composition (letter or report) marked on the official-style grid below.

ATTENTION How writing is marked at the Bac

At the Baccalauréat technique, written expression is marked out of 10 points : 4 points for content and coherence (contenu et cohérence), 3 points for organisation and connectors (organisation et connecteurs), 3 points for linguistic accuracy (correction linguistique : grammar, spelling, punctuation). Do not neglect any dimension — a brilliant idea written with poor grammar cannot score more than about 5/10.



Stacked-bar evaluation grid : class profile per skill after the formative evaluation (fictitious example). Grammar and Writing show the largest pink zones — they become the priority for remediation.

Reading the chart : if, like in this example, **Grammar** and **Writing** show the largest pink zones, the remediation workshops below will target them first.

6.3 Targeted Remediation Workshops

PROPRIÉTÉ Principles of effective remediation

Effective remediation is : targeted (one single notion at a time), short (15–20 minutes), interactive (a game or a contextualised exercise, never a lecture repeated), and assessed (a mini exit-test to check progress).

Students are assigned to one workshop according to the formative results. Each workshop lasts 20 minutes and ends with a 5-question exit quiz.

Workshop A — Grammar difficulties (comparisons and adverbs). Card game : match sentence halves (“This loan is twice...” / “...as expensive as the other.”). Then a “find the mistake” race : *I live here since five years ago → I have lived here **for** five years / **since** 2020.

Workshop B — Banking vocabulary. Word-wall and bingo with definitions : **deposit** (dépôt), **withdrawal** (retrait), **overdraft** (découvert), **interest rate** (taux d’intérêt), **statement** (relevé de compte). Exit task : label a mini bank statement with five of these words.

Workshop C — Writing structure. Rebuild a scrambled letter of complaint (paragraphs in envelopes), then highlight the connectors (first, moreover, however, finally) and the subordinate clauses. Exit task : write the opening and closing paragraphs of a complaint letter.

EXERCICE 11 Exit quiz — Workshop A

Choose the correct option : (1) I have been a customer here for / since 2019. (2) This account is as / so convenient as the mobile one. (3) The more you save, the more / the most interest you earn. (4) He left two hours ago / since. (5) Rice is cheaper / cheapest than imported pasta.

CORRIGÉ Exit quiz — Workshop A

(1) since (a starting date) ; (2) as (equality : as... as) ; (3) the more (double comparative) ; (4) ago (a finished past moment) ; (5) cheaper (comparison of two items).

6.4 Student Self-Assessment

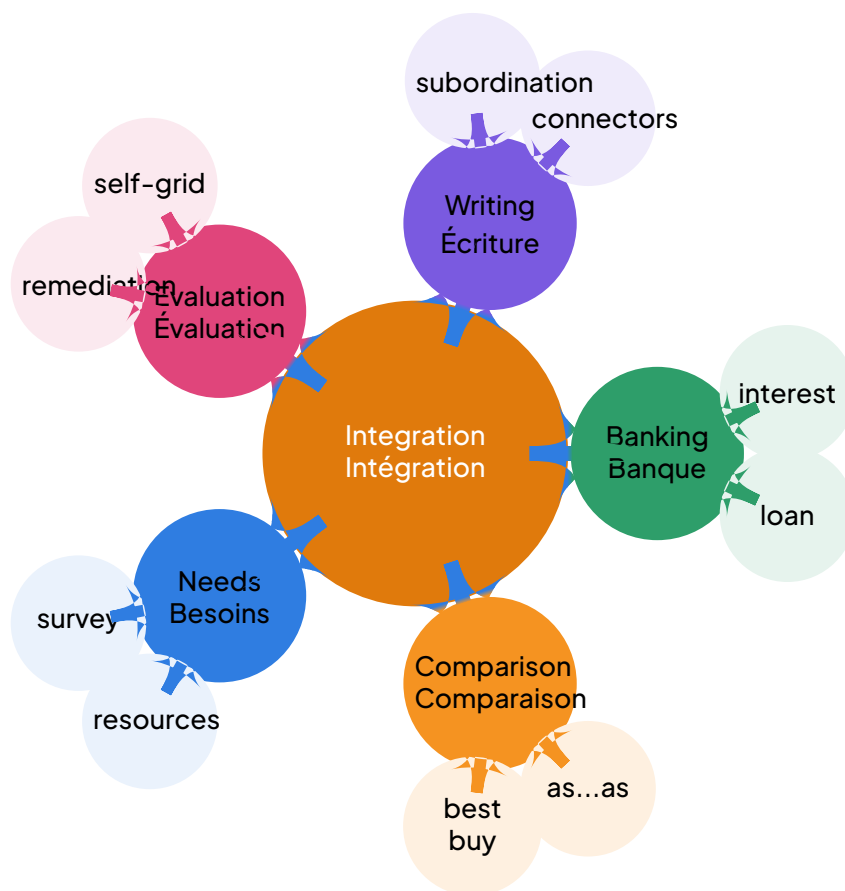
Each student completes the grid below honestly, then writes a personal action plan.

Lesson objective	I can do it	Not yet
I can ask questions to assess consumer needs and community services.	☐	☐
I can compare prices and quality (comparatives, equality, degree).	☐	☐
I can use adverbs of time correctly (for, since, ago, afterwards).	☐	☐
I can understand a text about banking services.	☐	☐
I can build complex sentences (coordination and subordination).	☐	☐
I can express my preferences (would rather, prefer... to).	☐	☐
I can write a 250–word composition about banking services.	☐	☐

Personal action plan — example. “I ticked ‘not yet’ for subordinate clauses and banking vocabulary. My plan : (1) I will revise relative clauses (who, which, that) for 15 minutes every evening this week ; (2) I will learn 10 banking words per week with flashcards ; (3) I will rewrite my complaint letter and ask the teacher for feedback before Friday.”

6.5 Cross-Curricular Links

- **Economics** : every purchase involves an **opportunity cost** (coût d’opportunité) — choosing supplier A means giving up the advantages of supplier B. The cooperative’s budget is a direct application of your economics course.
- **Mathematics** : comparing offers requires percentages (a 10 % **discount**), and banking requires interest calculations. Simple interest : $I = C \times t \times n$; for example, a deposit of 100000 FCFA at 5 % per year earns $100000 \times 0,05 \times 2 = 10000$ FCFA in two years. Compound interest (intérêts composés) grows faster because each year’s interest is added to the capital.
- **Citizenship education** : responsible consumption (avoiding waste, checking quality) and **financial inclusion** — giving every citizen, even in rural areas, access to a bank account and credit — are pillars of community development in Cameroon.



Mind map of the lesson's key concepts : needs lead to comparison, comparison to banking choices, banking to written argumentation, and everything converges towards integration and evaluation.

6.6 Preparing for the Probatoire and Baccalauréat

EXEMPLE A real-type Bac subject (Technical series, 2023)

“Write a letter to your bank manager complaining about unauthorized charges on your account (about 250 words).” A model answer is available on the MINESEC website. Notice the expected structure : address and date, formal greeting (Dear Sir/Madam), statement of the problem with dates and amounts, request for a refund, polite closing (Yours faithfully).

LESAVAIS-TU ? The “Case Study” at the Probatoire technique

The Probatoire technique often includes a banking case study : you receive an account sta-

tement (relevé de compte), you must detect errors (a duplicated charge, a wrong balance), and propose solutions in correct English. This is exactly the skill trained in the integrative project when your team checks the cooperative's figures.

MÉTHODE Analysing a typical exam paper

1. Reading comprehension : identify the text type (letter, statement, advert), then answer with words from the text and justify with line references.
2. Grammar in context : cloze exercises often test for/since/ago and comparatives — re-read the time marker before choosing (since + starting point, for + duration, ago + finished past).
3. Written expression : spend 5 minutes planning (3 paragraphs), 20 minutes writing, 5 minutes proofreading connectors and verb tenses.

À RETENIR Key points of Section 6

Integration means using all the lesson's skills together in a realistic project. Evaluation is a tool for progress, not a punishment : read your results, choose the right remediation workshop, and build a personal action plan. At the Bac, balance content, organisation and accuracy — and practise with real-type subjects (complaint letters, banking case studies) until the format becomes automatic.

7 ACTIVITÉ D'INTÉGRATION

8 LEÇON N02 : ECONOMIC LIFE AND OCCUPATIONS

8.1 Objectifs de l'activité

This integrative project (projet intégrateur) brings together all the skills of the unit **Economic Life and Occupations**. By the end of the activity, you will be able to :

- **Assess consumer needs** in your community using a questionnaire in English (évaluer les besoins des consommateurs).
- **Compare prices and quality** of suppliers to determine the best buys, using double comparatives and comparisons of equality and degree (comparer prix et qualité).
- **Analyse real banking offers** (interest rates, guarantees, fees) and write a formal loan application letter using coordination, subordination and expressions of preference (rédiger une demande de prêt).
- **Give and receive information orally** during a five-minute pitch in front of a "bank jury" (soutenance orale devant un jury).
- **Use adverbs of time** (for, since, ago, after, afterwards) correctly in speech and writing.

À RETENIR

Compétences mobilised

Speaking : giving and receiving information. Vocabulary : consumer needs, best buys, banking services. Grammar : comparisons (double, equality, degree), adverbs of time, coordination, subordination, expressing preferences. Reading : banking documents. Writing : a formal letter and a business plan summary.

8.2 Situation

Project : "Coopérative Agropastorale Jeunesse" – Business Plan & Bank Pitch

You are a group of five young school-leavers in **Bafoussam, West Region of Cameroon**. You want to create a youth cooperative (coopérative) that will raise broiler chickens (poulets de chair) and process cassava into gari (transformation du manioc). To obtain a loan (prêt) from a bank or a microfinance institution, you must prepare a complete file and defend it orally.

Data collected during your community survey (50 households interviewed) :

Rank	Community need	Households concerned
1	Affordable source of animal protein (chicken meat)	41 out of 50 (82 %)
2	Good-quality gari at stable prices	36 out of 50 (72 %)
3	Local jobs for young people	29 out of 50 (58 %)

Three suppliers of inputs (fournisseurs d'intrants) for 1 000 chicks and feed for one production cycle of 8 weeks :

Supplier	Price per chick (FCFA)	Feed per 50 kg bag (FCFA)	Quality / reliability
SODEPA Yaoundé	600	19 500	Vaccinated chicks, delivery in 2 days, very reliable
Ferme Nkoulou (Bafoussam)	550	18 000	Vaccinated chicks, local, sometimes late
Marché Mfoundi (informal)	400	16 500	Not always vaccinated, no guarantee

Two financing offers for a loan of 15 000 000 FCFA over 24 months :

Feature	Crédit Agricole (Offer A)	Microfinance "Confiance" (Offer B)
Annual interest rate (taux d'intérêt)	8 %	15 %
Guarantee (garantie)	Land title or guarantor	Group solidarity only
File fees (frais de dossier)	25 000 FCFA	10 000 FCFA
Decision time	6 weeks	1 week
Grace period (différé de remboursement)	3 months	None

Expected results per cycle (8 weeks) : 950 chickens sold at 3 500 FCFA each ; cost of production about 240 000 FCFA per cycle of 1 000 chicks including feed, vaccines and labour.

LESAVAIS-TU ? Contexte bancaire camerounais

Au Cameroun, les jeunes entrepreneurs peuvent s'adresser aux banques commerciales (ex. Crédit Agricole, Afriland First Bank, UBA) ou aux institutions de microfinance (IMF) agréées par la COBAC. Les banques exigent souvent des garanties réelles (titre foncier, caution) mais offrent des taux plus bas (7–10 %). Les IMF acceptent la garantie solidaire de groupe, mais leurs taux sont plus élevés (12–18 %). Le choix dépend de la capacité de

garantie et de l'urgence du financement.

8.3 Consignes

Work in groups of four or five. Answer the following tasks in English. Each task uses skills from the unit.

1. **Community needs.** Using the survey table, write three sentences identifying the three priority needs. Use comparisons of degree (e.g. "Chicken meat is the most urgent need because..."). Then design two extra questionnaire questions you would ask households.
2. **Best buy.** Compare the three suppliers in a short paragraph. Use at least : one double comparative ("the cheaper the chicks, the higher the risk"), one comparison of equality ("as reliable as"), and one superlative. Justify your final choice of supplier.
3. **Unit price calculation.** Compute the total cost of 1 000 chicks plus 40 bags of feed for each supplier. Which supplier is the cheapest? Which one offers the best value for money (le meilleur rapport qualité-prix)? Explain the difference.
4. **Banking analysis.** Read the two financing offers. Extract the interest rate, the guarantee and the fees for each. Compute the total interest paid over two years for Offer A (simple interest : $I = C \times t \times n$). Say which offer you prefer and why, using expressions of preference ("We would rather...", "We prefer... to...").
5. **Formal letter.** Write the loan application letter (150–180 words) to the institution you chose. Use at least two coordinated sentences (and, but, so) and two subordinated sentences (because, although, if, so that).
6. **Pitch preparation.** Prepare a five-minute oral pitch with four parts : needs, market, profitability, repayment plan. Use adverbs of time correctly : "We have worked on this project for six months", "We started our survey two months ago", "After the first cycle, we will repay...".
7. **Jury simulation.** Two classmates and the teacher play the bankers. They ask questions with conditionals and concession : "What will you do if the price of feed increases?" "Although your project is interesting, why is it not risky?" Answer politely and justify.
8. **Self-evaluation.** Fill in the skills grid and identify your two weakest points for remediation.

8.4 Ressources à mobiliser

À RETENIR

Grammar toolbox

- Double comparative : the + comparative..., the + comparative... ("The more we produce, the more we earn.")
- Equality : as + adjective + as ("Ferme Nkoulou is almost as reliable as SODEPA.")

- Degree : too + adjective, adjective + enough (“The informal market is too risky.”)
- Adverbs of time : for + duration, since + starting point, ago (past), after / afterwards.
- Coordination : and, but, or, so, yet. Subordination : because, although, if, when, so that, whereas.
- Preferences : prefer X to Y, would rather + base verb, would prefer + to-infinitive.

À RETENIR Key vocabulary

consumer needs (besoins des consommateurs), **survey** (enquête), **supplier** (fournisseur), **unit price** (prix unitaire), **value for money** (rapport qualité-prix), **loan** (prêt), **interest rate** (taux d'intérêt), **guarantee** (garantie), **fees** (frais), **repayment** (remboursement), **profit** (bénéfice), **savings account** (compte épargne), **grace period** (différé de remboursement), **broiler chickens** (poulets de chair).

MÉTHODE Simple interest formula

For a loan of capital C at annual rate t (as a decimal) over n years :

$$I = C \times t \times n$$

The total amount to repay is $C + I + \text{fees}$.

8.5 Démarche et corrigé commenté

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 9 Model answer – Group “Jeunesse Agropastorale”

Task 1 – Community needs.

Énoncé : identify the three priority needs and write two extra questions.

SOLUTION

Solution : “If the price of feed increases, we will buy maize locally and mix our own feed. Although our project is new, it is not very risky because the demand for chicken is very high in Bafoussam.”

ATTENTION Common mistakes to avoid

Do not say “more cheaper” (double marking of the comparative). Use *for* with a duration and *since* with a starting point : “for six months” but “since January”. “Ago” always comes after the duration : “two months ago”. In the formal letter, avoid contractions (write *we are*, not *we’re*). Do not confuse “after” (preposition/conjunction) and “afterwards” (adverb) : “After the cycle” vs “We will repay afterwards”.

8.6 Bilan de l’activité

This project has shown that English is a real working tool (un outil de travail) for economic life in Cameroon. You have used the whole unit in one authentic task :

- **Speaking** : you gave and received information during the survey, the pitch and the jury simulation.
- **Comparisons** : double comparatives, equality and degree helped you justify the best buy and the best bank offer.
- **Adverbs of time** : *for*, *since*, *ago*, *after* and *afterwards* structured your project timeline.
- **Complex sentences** : coordination and subordination made your letter and your answers clear and professional ; expressions of preference justified your choices.
- **Reading and writing** : you read real banking documents and produced a formal loan application letter.
- **Calculation** : unit prices and simple interest proved that a good decision must be justified with figures (justifiée par des chiffres).

The self-evaluation grid identifies your weak points (for example : subordination, adverbs of time, or pronunciation of numbers). The remediation session will focus on these points with short targeted exercises before the final evaluation. A well-defended business plan can really convince a bank : your English is now part of your professional future.

9 MÉTHODES ET EXERCICES RÉSOLUS

9.1 Applying the lesson to real-life situations

MÉTHODE Comparing prices and quality to find the best buy

To compare products and choose the best buy, follow these steps :

1. Identify the **price** and the **quality** (size, weight, durability, brand) of each product.
2. Use the correct form of comparison : as ... as (equality), more ... than / -er than (superiority), less ... than (inferiority), the most / the -est (superlative).
3. Use the **double comparison** for linked changes : the cheaper, the better.
4. Compare the price per unit (per kilo, per litre) when quantities differ : divide the price by the quantity.
5. Conclude with a clear recommendation and justify it with one argument of price and one of quality.

Key phrases : value for money (rapport qualité-prix), a bargain (une bonne affaire), to be worth it (en valoir la peine).

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 10 Choosing the best buy at the market

Task (Bac-type) : At Mokolo market, shop A sells a 5 kg bag of rice for 3000 FCFA and shop B sells a 10 kg bag of the same rice for 5500 FCFA. Write a short paragraph (5–6 lines) comparing the two offers and recommending the best buy. Use at least two comparative structures.

SOLUTION

Step 1 – Compute the price per kilo.

$$\text{Shop A : } 3000 \div 5 = 600 \text{ FCFA per kg}$$

$$\text{Shop B : } 5500 \div 10 = 550 \text{ FCFA per kg}$$

Step 2 – Compare. Shop B's rice is cheaper per kilo : $550 < 600$. The difference is $600 - 550 = 50$ FCFA per kg. Step 3 – Write the paragraph with comparatives.

Shop A sells rice at 600 FCFA per kilo, whereas shop B sells the same rice at 550 FCFA per kilo. Shop B's rice is therefore cheaper than shop A's, although the bag is bigger and heavier to carry. The quality is as good as shop A's, since it is the same brand. The more you buy at shop B, the more you save : 500 FCFA on a 10 kg bag. I recommend shop B because it offers the best value for money.

Conclusion : Shop B is the best buy : the unit price is lower (550 against 600 FCFA/kg) for

an equal quality.

MÉTHODE Using time adverbs : for, since, ago, after, afterwards

1. **for** + duration (a period) : for two years, for six months. Used with the present perfect : I have banked with UBA for five years.
 2. **since** + starting point (a date or event) : since 2020, since last January. Also with the present perfect.
 3. **ago** + past point in time, counted back from now : two days ago. Used with the simple past, always placed after the time expression.
 4. **after** + noun or clause (order of events) : After opening the account, he received a card.
 5. **afterwards** (adverb, alone) : We signed the contract ; afterwards, we went home.
- Reflex : ask “duration or starting point ?” If duration → for ; if starting point → since.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 11 Completing a dialogue with time adverbs

Task : Complete with for, since, ago, after or afterwards.

1. Mme Etoundi has been a customer of Afriland ... 2019.
2. She opened her first savings account ten years
3. ... filling in the form, she showed her ID card.
4. She has used mobile banking ... three years.
5. He deposited the cheque and left the bank

SOLUTION

Solutions and justifications :

1. since – 2019 is a starting point, and the verb is in the present perfect (has been).
2. ago – “ten years” is counted back from now ; the verb opened is in the simple past.
3. After – it introduces a sequence of two actions and is followed by a verb in -ing (filling).
4. for – “three years” is a duration with the present perfect (has used).
5. afterwards – it stands alone at the end of the sentence, meaning “then, after that”.

Conclusion : since ; ago ; After ; for ; afterwards.

MÉTHODE Building complex sentences : coordination and subordination

1. Coordination links two independent clauses with **and** (addition), **but** (contrast), **or** (choice), **so** (result) : The bank is safe, but the fees are high.
2. Subordination links a main clause and a dependent clause with **because** (cause), **although/though** (concession), **when, while** (time), **if** (condition), **so that** (purpose), **who/which/that** (relative).
3. Check that the dependent clause cannot stand alone : if it starts with because/although/when, it needs a main clause.
4. Punctuation : when the subordinate clause comes first, add a comma : Although the fees are high, the bank is safe.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 12 Combining sentences about banking services

Task : Combine each pair of sentences using the connector in brackets.

1. Many Cameroonians use mobile money. It is fast and convenient. (because)
2. The interest rate is low. A savings account is still useful. (although)
3. You can withdraw money. The ATM is working. (if)

SOLUTION

Step 1 – Identify the logical relation : (1) cause, (2) concession, (3) condition. Step 2 – Choose the main clause (the most important idea) and attach the subordinate clause. Step 3 – Write and punctuate.

1. Many Cameroonians use mobile money because it is fast and convenient. (No comma : the subordinate clause comes second.)
2. Although the interest rate is low, a savings account is still useful. (Comma after the fronted subordinate clause.)
3. You can withdraw money if the ATM is working.

Conclusion : each sentence now has one main clause and one subordinate clause, correctly linked and punctuated.

MÉTHODE Expressing preferences

1. **prefer + noun/ -ing + to** : I prefer cash to cheques. / I prefer saving to borrowing.
2. **would rather + base verb + than** : I would rather save than borrow. (No -ing, no to be-)

fore the verb.)

3. **would prefer + to-infinitive** : I would prefer to open a joint account.
 4. **like ... better than / favourite** : I like mobile banking better than queuing at the counter.
 5. To justify a preference, add because + reason : ... because it saves time.
- Reflex : after would rather, never write to or -ing.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 13 Expressing your banking preferences

Task : Rewrite using the structure in brackets.

1. I like mobile money more than bank cheques. (prefer)
2. She wants to save money, not to take a loan. (would rather ... than)
3. We want to use an ATM. (would prefer)

SOLUTION

Solutions :

1. I prefer mobile money to bank cheques. – Structure : prefer + noun + to + noun.
2. She would rather save money than take a loan. – Base verbs save and take, no to, no -ing.
3. We would prefer to use an ATM. – would prefer + to-infinitive.

Conclusion : the three structures are prefer X to Y, would rather V than V, would prefer to V.

MÉTHODE Writing a composition about banking services

1. Plan in three parts : introduction (present the topic), body (2–3 arguments with examples from Cameroon : mobile money, savings accounts, loans, ATMs), conclusion (your opinion).
2. Use linkers : first, moreover, however, for example, in addition, to conclude.
3. Include at least one comparison, one complex sentence (subordination) and one preference.
4. Use the vocabulary of the unit : account, deposit, withdrawal, loan, interest, fees, transfer, balance.

5. Proofread : subject-verb agreement, verb tenses, spelling of numbers and currency (FCFA).

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 14 Guided composition : “Why I opened a bank account”

Task (Bac-type) : Write a 120–150 word composition entitled “Why I opened a bank account”. Use at least one comparative, one subordinate clause and one expression of preference.

SOLUTION

Model answer :

Last year, I opened a savings account at a microfinance bank in Yaoundé because I wanted to keep my money safe. First, a bank account is safer than keeping cash at home, where it can be stolen. Moreover, my savings earn interest, so my money grows little by little. Although the bank charges small fees, the service is worth it. I prefer mobile banking to queuing at the counter, since it is faster and I can check my balance at any time. For example, I transfer money to my mother in the village in one minute. The more I save, the more confident I feel about my future. To conclude, opening a bank account was one of the best decisions of my life, and I advise every young Cameroonian to do the same. (128 words)

Checklist : comparative (safer than, faster), subordination (because, although, since), preference (I prefer ... to), double comparison (the more ... the more), linkers (first, moreover, for example, to conclude).

MÉTHODE Assessing consumer needs and community resources (speaking)

1. Ask for information with polite questions : What do you need most? How much can you spend? Which services are available in your neighbourhood?
2. Give information clearly : Our community has a health centre, two schools and a market, but there is no clean water supply.
3. Assess needs by ranking them : The most urgent need is... / Water is more important than...
4. Suggest solutions with should, could, why don't we... : The council should build a borehole.
5. Conclude the exchange by summarising the decision.

EXERCICE RÉSOLU 15 Dialogue : assessing community needs

Task : Complete the dialogue between a development worker (W) and a villager (V).

1. W : ... (ask what the village needs most)
2. V : We need clean water more than anything else.
3. W : ... (ask if there is a health centre)
4. V : Yes, but it is smaller and less equipped than the one in town.
5. W : ... (suggest building a borehole)

SOLUTION

Possible answers :

1. What does your village need most ? – open question with What ... most.
2. Is there a health centre in your village ? – yes/no question, inversion of there is.
3. Why don't we build a borehole near the market ? or The community should build a borehole. – suggestion with why don't we or should.

Conclusion : the exchange assesses needs (water first), compares resources (smaller, less equipped than) and proposes a solution – exactly the speaking function required by the programme.

ATTENTION Les 5 erreurs qui coûtent des points au Bac

1. Double marque de comparaison : ne jamais écrire more cheaper ou the most easiest. On choisit cheaper OU more expensive, jamais les deux ensemble.
2. Confondre for et since : for + durée (for two years), since + point de départ (since 2022). Et ago se place après la durée avec le prétérit : two years ago, jamais since two years ago.
3. Would rather suivi de to ou de -ing : la bonne forme est would rather + base verbale : I would rather save (pas to save, pas saving).
4. Phrase subordonnée laissée seule : Because the bank was closed. n'est pas une phrase complète. Il faut une proposition principale : Because the bank was closed, I used the ATM.
5. Comparaison de prix sans ramener à l'unité : comparer deux prix sans calculer le prix au kilo ou au litre fausse le raisonnement. Toujours diviser le prix par la quantité avant de conclure, et justifier la recommandation par un argument de prix ET un argument de qualité.

10 EXERCICES**10.1 Je vérifie mes connaissances****EXERCICE 12 QCM : Vocabulary & Grammar Basics**

Choose the correct option (a, b, or c) to complete each sentence.

1. The new smartphone is _____ expensive _____ the old model. (Equality comparison)
a) as / than
b) so / as
c) as / as
2. We have been waiting for the bank manager _____ 10 :00 a.m. (Adverb of time)
a) since
b) for
c) ago
3. A _____ is an asset that a borrower offers to a lender to secure a loan. (Banking vocabulary)
a) overdraft
b) collateral
c) interest rate
4. _____ the high interest rates, many small businesses still apply for loans. (Subordination / Concession)
a) Because
b) Although
c) So
5. I _____ save money in a credit union rather than keep it at home. (Preference)
a) would rather
b) prefer to
c) like

EXERCICE 13 True / False Justified

Read the statements below. Write True or False and justify your answer with a sentence from the lesson or your knowledge.

1. Assessing consumer needs means identifying what the seller wants to produce.
2. Community resources include only financial institutions like banks.
3. "Double comparison" structure (The more..., the more...) is used to show a proportional relationship.
4. A savings account generally offers a higher interest rate than a current (checking) account.
5. "Since" is used with a duration (e.g., since three years) and "for" with a starting point (e.g., for 2020).

EXERCICE 14 Definitions & Key Concepts

Define the following terms in your own words (in English). Give a short example for each.

1. Consumer needs assessment (évaluation des besoins des consommateurs)
2. Collateral (garantie / collatéral)
3. Overdraft (découvert bancaire)
4. Double comparison (comparaison double / proportionnelle)
5. Mobile banking (banque mobile)

EXERCICE 15 Grammar Quick Practice

Rewrite the following sentences using the words in brackets. Do not change the meaning.

1. The loan term is long. The interest paid is high. (The longer... the higher...)
2. This bank offers good services. That bank offers better services. (not as... as)
3. He opened his account five years ago. He still uses it. (for / since)
4. She has a low income. She got a microfinance loan. (Although / Despite)
5. I think saving in a bank is better than mobile money. (would rather)

10.2 Je m'entraîne

EXERCICE 16 Reading & Table Completion : Smart Shopping

Read the text comparing two laptop offers for a student association. Complete the comparison table below.

Text : The association "Tech Future" needs a laptop. Offer A (Shop X) : Price 450,000 FCFA. Warranty : 2 years. Specs : 8GB RAM, 256GB SSD, Core i5. Offer B (Shop Y) : Price 400,000 FCFA. Warranty : 1 year. Specs : 4GB RAM, 500GB HDD, Core i3. The treasurer thinks Offer A is the best buy because the processor is faster and the SSD is more reliable than HDD, even if it is more expensive.

Criteria	Offer A (Shop X)	Offer B (Shop Y)
Price (FCFA)		
Warranty		
Processor (CPU)		
RAM		
Storage Type / Size		
Best Buy ? (Justify in 1 sentence)		

EXERCICE 17 Grammar : Complex Sentences & Preferences

Combine the pairs of sentences using the linking word in brackets. Make any necessary changes.

1. The interest rate dropped. Many people borrowed money. (As / Because)
2. The client signed the contract. He did not read the terms. (without / -ing)
3. You must provide collateral. The bank will not approve the loan. (Unless)
4. Mobile money is convenient. Traditional banks offer more security. (While / Whereas)
5. I want to open a current account. I want a debit card. (not only... but also)
6. He prefers investing in land. He does not trust the stock market. (prefer... to... / would rather... than)

EXERCICE 18 Vocabulary in Context : Banking Services

Fill in the blanks with the appropriate word from the box. Two words are extra.

overdraft interest rate collateral withdrawal deposit statement loan
savings account standing order mobile banking

1. Every month, the bank sends me a _____ showing all my transactions.
2. To get a large _____, the entrepreneur used his land as _____.
3. I set up a _____ to pay my rent automatically on the 1st of each month.
4. The _____ on this savings account is 3.5% per year.
5. She made a large _____ yesterday to pay her suppliers.
6. With _____, I can check my balance on my phone without going to the agency.
7. Be careful! If you spend more than you have, you will go into _____ and pay fees.

EXERCICE 19 Speaking / Writing : Assessing Community Resources

Scenario : You are a member of a Youth Agricultural Cooperative in your village. You need to assess the community resources available to start a poultry farm.

Task : Write a short report (80–100 words) answering these questions :

1. What are the human resources available (skills, labour)?
2. What financial services (banks, microfinance, tontines) exist nearby?
3. What material resources (land, water, feed suppliers) are accessible?
4. What is the main need you must request help for (training, funding, equipment)?

Use linking words : Firstly, Moreover, However, Therefore.

10.3 Je me prépare au Bac

EXERCICE 20 Bac Type : Formal Email – Banking Services

Context : You are the Secretary General of the “Young Entrepreneurs Association” (YEA) in Douala. Your association wants to open a savings account to manage membership fees and project funds.

Task : Write a formal email to the Manager of Afriland First Bank, Douala Branch.

- Subject line : Request for Information – Opening Association Savings Account.
- Body : Introduce the association (legal status, number of members, purpose).
- Ask specific questions about : minimum opening deposit, monthly maintenance fees, interest rate on savings, conditions for withdrawal, and mobile banking / USSD options for members in remote areas.
- Request an appointment to finalize the procedure.

- Use formal register : Dear Sir/Madam, I am writing to inquire..., Could you please provide..., We would appreciate..., Yours faithfully.

Word count : 200–250 words.

EXERCICE 21 Bac Type : Grammar Synthesis & Reading Comprehension

Part A : Grammar Transformation (5 marks) Rewrite the sentences as instructed.

1. The repayment period is long. The total cost of the credit is high. (Begin with : The longer...)
2. The microfinance institution approved the loan. The applicant had no collateral. (Begin with : Despite...)
3. "When did you open this account?" the clerk asked me. (Reported speech : The clerk asked me...)
4. I started using mobile money in 2019. I still use it daily. (Use : since / for in two separate sentences)
5. My father prefers keeping cash at home. He does not trust banks. (Use : would rather... than)

Part B : Reading Comprehension (10 marks) Read the extract from a CRTV "Eco d'ici" report on agricultural financing and answer the questions.

"In the Centre Region, the 'Green Valley' cooperative struggled to expand their maize production. Local banks required land titles as collateral, which most members lacked. Then, a partner NGO introduced a 'Warehouse Receipt System'. Farmers store harvested maize in a certified warehouse. They receive a receipt proving ownership and quantity. This receipt serves as collateral for a bank loan up to 70% of the crop's value. The interest rate is 5% per annum, subsidized by the state. The loan duration is 6 months, matching the storage period. The advantage : farmers sell when prices are high, not at harvest. The risk : if prices drop, the sale might not cover the loan."

1. Why couldn't the cooperative get a traditional bank loan initially? (2 marks)
2. Explain how the Warehouse Receipt System works. (3 marks)
3. What are the loan conditions (rate, duration, percentage of value)? (3 marks)
4. State one advantage and one risk mentioned in the text. (2 marks)

EXERCICE 22 Bac Type : Argumentative Essay + Practical Case

Part A : Argumentative Essay (10 marks) Topic : "Mobile money services (Orange Money, MTN MoMo) will completely replace traditional banks in Cameroon within the next ten

years.”

Instructions : Write a structured essay (Introduction, Body, Conclusion).

- Introduction : Hook, define the topic, announce plan.
- Body Paragraph 1 (For) : 2 arguments why mobile money could replace banks (accessibility, low cost, financial inclusion for unbanked).
- Body Paragraph 2 (Against) : 2 arguments why banks remain essential (large loans, security/regulation, business services, international trade).
- Conclusion : Summarize, give your personal opinion (nuanced).

Requirements : Use linking words (Furthermore, However, On the one hand, Conversely, In conclusion). Use vocabulary : unbanked population, transaction fees, creditworthiness, regulatory framework, financial inclusion. Length : 250–300 words.

Part B : Practical Case – Bank Statement Analysis (10 marks) Below is a fictitious bank statement for “Mme Ngo Bakang” (Current Account n° 1002345) for January 2026.

Date	Description	Debit (FCFA)	Credit (FCFA)	Balance (FCFA)
01/01	Opening Balance			150,000
05/01	Salary Deposit		300,000	450,000
10/01	ATM Withdrawal	50,000		400,000
12/01	Transfer to Supplier (Invoice 44)	120,000		280,000
15/01	Bank Fees (Monthly)	5,500		274,500
20/01	POS Payment Supermarket	45,000		229,500
25/01	Interest Credit		1,200	230,700
28/01	Unknown Debit “COM*”	15,000		215,700
31/01	Closing Balance			215,700

Questions :

1. Verify the final balance (215,700 FCFA) by calculating step by step. Show your work. (3 marks)
2. Identify two anomalies or suspicious entries in the statement. Explain why. (4 marks)
3. Write a formal complaint letter (email format) to the Bank Manager regarding the anomalies.
 - Use : “I would like to draw your attention to...”, “I would rather...”, “Unless this is rectified...”.
 - Request a reversal and an explanation.
 (3 marks)

11 CORRIGÉS DES EXERCICES

CORRIGÉ Exercice 1 — QCM : Vocabulary & Grammar Basics

1. c) **as / as**. Equality comparison : as + adjective + as. "So... as" is only used in negative sentences (not so expensive as).
2. a) **since**. Since + starting point (10 :00 a.m.). For + duration ; ago is placed after the duration (two hours ago).
3. b) **collateral** (garantie). An **overdraft** is a negative balance ; an **interest rate** is the cost of borrowing.
4. b) **Although**. Concession : the result is unexpected. "Because" would express cause, "so" consequence.
5. a) **would rather**. Structure : would rather + base verb ... rather than + base verb. "Prefer to" cannot be followed by "rather than" in this pattern.

Points de vigilance : ne pas confondre since (point de départ) et for (durée) ; la structure would rather + BV exige le verbe de base, sans to.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 2 — True / False Justified

1. False. Assessing **consumer needs** means identifying what consumers (the community) want or need, not what the seller wants to produce.
2. False. **Community resources** also include human resources (skills, labour), material resources (land, water, markets) and social services (schools, health centres), not only banks.
3. True. The longer the loan term, the higher the total interest shows that two quantities change together proportionally (**double comparative**).
4. True. **Savings accounts** are remunerated (e.g., around 3% per year in many Cameroonian institutions), while **current accounts** usually earn little or no interest.
5. False. It is the opposite : since + starting point (since 2020), for + duration (for three years).

Points de vigilance : la justification est exigée pour chaque item ; une réponse "True/False" seule ne vaut pas la totalité des points.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 3 — Definitions & Key Concepts

Expected elements (accept any correct formulation) :

1. **Assessing consumer needs** : The process of finding out what goods or services the people of a community want, need and can pay for. Example : before opening a shop, the trader asks households which products they buy most.
2. **Collateral** : A valuable asset (land title, vehicle, warehouse receipt) that a borrower gives the bank as security for a loan ; the bank can seize it if the loan is not repaid. Example : a farmer uses his land title as collateral.
3. **Overdraft** : A situation where an account holder spends more money than the balance ; the bank allows a negative balance but charges fees and interest. Example : his account shows -20 000 FCFA, so he is in overdraft.
4. **Double comparative** : A structure with two comparatives showing that two things change together : the + comparative..., the + comparative.... Example : The more you save, the richer you become.
5. **Mobile banking** : Banking operations (balance check, transfer, payment) done on a mobile phone, by app or USSD code, without going to the agency. Example : she pays her supplier by mobile banking from her village.

Points de vigilance : une définition complète = nature/fonction + exemple ; éviter les définitions circulaires ("an overdraft is when you are in overdraft").

CORRIGÉ Exercice 4 — Grammar Quick Practice

1. The longer the loan term, the higher the interest paid.
2. This bank does not offer services as good as that bank. (ou : This bank's services are not as good as that bank's.)
3. He has used his account for five years. / He has used his account since 2021 (five years ago).
4. Although she has a low income, she got a microfinance loan. / Despite her low income, she got a microfinance loan.
5. I would rather save money in a bank than use mobile money.

Points de vigilance : avec since/for, utiliser le present perfect (has used), pas le prétérit ; despite est suivi d'un nom ou d'un V-ing, jamais d'une phrase complète avec sujet + verbe conjugué.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 5 — Reading & Table Completion : Smart Shopping

Criteria	Offer A (Shop X)	Offer B (Shop Y)
Price (FCFA)	450,000	400,000
Warranty	2 years	1 year
Processor (CPU)	Core i5 (faster)	Core i3 (slower)
RAM	8 GB	4 GB
Storage Type / Size	256 GB SSD (more reliable)	500 GB HDD (larger but slower)
Best Buy?	Offer A : although it is 50,000 FCFA more expensive, it is faster, more reliable and has a longer warranty, so it is better value for money.	

Vérification du calcul d'écart : $450\,000 - 400\,000 = 50\,000$ FCFA, soit $\frac{50\,000}{400\,000} \times 100 = 12,5\%$ de plus que l'offre B. Points de vigilance : la justification doit comparer prix et qualité (garantie, performance); un "best buy" n'est pas forcément le moins cher, mais le meilleur rapport qualité-prix.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 6 — Grammar : Complex Sentences & Preferences

1. As / Because the interest rate dropped, many people borrowed money. (**Subordination of cause**)
2. The client signed the contract without reading the terms. (**Preposition + V-ing**)
3. Unless you provide collateral, the bank will not approve the loan. (**Condition : unless = if not**)
4. While / Whereas mobile money is convenient, traditional banks offer more security. (**Contrast**)
5. I want not only to open a current account but also to get a debit card. (ou : I want to open not only a current account but also a debit card.) (**Correlative coordination**)
6. He prefers investing in land to investing in the stock market. / He would rather invest in land than trust the stock market. (**Preference structures**)

Points de vigilance : unless = "if... not", donc ne pas ajouter une négation dans la subordonnée; prefer V-ing to V-ing (les deux verbes en -ing); without + V-ing.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 7 — Vocabulary in Context : Banking Services

1. **statement** (relevé de compte)
2. **loan**; **collateral**
3. **standing order** (ordre de virement permanent)
4. **interest rate**
5. **withdrawal** (retrait) — elle sort de l'argent pour payer ses fournisseurs
6. **mobile banking**
7. **overdraft**

Extra words : deposit, savings account. Points de vigilance : distinguer withdrawal (retrait) et deposit (dépôt); standing order = paiement automatique régulier, à ne pas confondre avec un simple transfer.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 8 — Speaking / Writing : Assessing Community Resources

Model answer (about 95 words) :

Firstly, our cooperative has strong human resources : twelve active young members, and two of them have experience in poultry keeping. Moreover, the village has a microfinance office and a weekly tontine, so small loans are possible. Concerning material resources, we own a plot of land near a stream, and a feed supplier operates in the neighbouring town. However, we have no training in disease prevention and no money to buy chicks and vaccines. Therefore, our main need is funding and technical training. We request support from the MINADER delegation and a microfinance loan.

Barème indicatif : contenu (4 questions traitées) : 4 pts; connecteurs exigés (Firstly, Moreover, However, Therefore) : 2 pts; vocabulaire de l'unité : 2 pts; grammaire et orthographe : 2 pts. Points de vigilance : respecter la fourchette 80–100 mots; répondre aux quatre questions dans l'ordre; employer les quatre connecteurs demandés.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 9 — Bac Type : Formal Email – Banking Services

Model answer (about 220 words) :

Subject : Request for Information – Opening Association Savings Account

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to inquire about the conditions for opening a savings account at your Douala branch. I am the Secretary General of the Young Entrepreneurs Association (YEA), a legally registered association with forty-five active members. Our purpose is to promote youth entrepreneurship through training and small income-generating projects.

We would like to open a savings account to manage membership fees and project funds safely. Could you please provide us with the following information? Firstly, what is the minimum opening deposit required for an association account? Secondly, what are the monthly maintenance fees? Thirdly, what interest rate do you offer on savings, and how often is the interest paid? Moreover, we would like to know the conditions for withdrawal : is a notice period necessary, and are there limits on the amount? Finally, since some of our members live in remote areas, we would appreciate details about your mobile banking and USSD services, including transaction fees.

We would be grateful if you could also indicate the documents required, such as our registration certificate and the minutes of our general assembly.

Could we arrange an appointment next week to finalize the procedure? Thank you in advance for your assistance.

Yours faithfully,

[Name], Secretary General, Young Entrepreneurs Association, Douala.

Barème indicatif (20 pts) : format email (objet, salutation, formule finale) : 3 pts ; présentation de l'association : 3 pts ; les 5 questions précises posées : 5 pts ; demande de rendez-vous : 2 pts ; registre formel et expressions imposées : 4 pts ; exactitude linguistique : 3 pts. Points de vigilance : Yours faithfully (et non sincerely) quand le destinataire n'est pas nommé ; registre formel : pas de contractions (I am, pas I'm) ; toutes les questions de la consigne doivent apparaître.

CORRIGÉ Exercice 10 — Bac Type : Grammar Synthesis & Reading Comprehension

Part A (5 marks, 1 mark each) :

1. The longer the repayment period, the higher the total cost of the credit.
2. Despite having no collateral, the applicant got the loan approved by the microfinance institution. (ou : Despite the fact that the applicant had no collateral, the microfinance institution approved the loan.)
3. The clerk asked me when I had opened that account.
4. I have used mobile money since 2019. / I have used mobile money for seven years (since 2019).
5. My father would rather keep cash at home than trust banks.

Points de vigilance (Part A) : en discours rapporté, recul des temps (did you open → had opened) et this → that ; avec since/for, present perfect obligatoire.

Part B (10 marks) :

1. Because local banks required land titles as collateral, and most cooperative members did not have land titles. (2 marks)
2. Farmers store their harvested maize in a certified warehouse (1 mark) ; they receive a receipt proving ownership and quantity (1 mark) ; this receipt is used as collateral to

obtain a bank loan (1 mark).

3. Interest rate : 5% per annum, subsidized by the state (1 mark); duration : 6 months, matching the storage period (1 mark); amount : up to 70% of the crop's value (1 mark).
4. Advantage : farmers can sell when prices are high instead of selling cheaply at harvest (1 mark). Risk : if prices drop, the sale of the maize might not cover the loan repayment (1 mark).

Points de vigilance (Part B) : répondre en phrases complètes en s'appuyant sur le texte ; ne pas recopier tout le passage ; pour la question 3, citer les trois conditions (taux, durée, pourcentage).

CORRIGÉ Exercice 11 — Bac Type : Argumentative Essay + Practical Case

Part A – Marking guide and model outline (10 marks) :

Introduction : In Cameroon, mobile money has grown spectacularly : millions of people now send and receive money with a simple telephone. Some observers claim that services like Orange Money and MTN Mobile Money will completely replace traditional banks within ten years. This essay will examine both sides of the argument before giving a personal opinion.

Body 1 (For) : On the one hand, mobile money is accessible everywhere, even in villages where there is no bank agency ; a simple kiosk is enough. Furthermore, transaction fees are low and opening an account takes a few minutes, which favours the financial inclusion of the unbanked population.

Body 2 (Against) : However, traditional banks remain essential. Only banks can grant large loans, because they assess the creditworthiness of borrowers and operate under a strict regulatory framework. Conversely, mobile money offers neither important credit nor international trade services such as letters of credit, which businesses need.

Conclusion : In conclusion, although mobile money will keep growing, it will probably complement rather than replace banks, because the two systems answer different needs.

Barème indicatif (Part A) : structure Intro/Body/Conclusion : 2 pts ; 2 arguments "for" + 2 arguments "against" : 4 pts ; connecteurs et vocabulaire imposés : 2 pts ; opinion personnelle nuancée et exactitude linguistique : 2 pts. Points de vigilance : respecter 250–300 mots ; donner une opinion personnelle en conclusion ; employer au moins trois des mots imposés (unbanked population, transaction fees, creditworthiness, regulatory framework, financial inclusion).

Part B (10 marks) :

1. Step-by-step verification :

$$\begin{aligned}150\,000 + 300\,000 &= 450\,000 \\450\,000 - 50\,000 &= 400\,000 \\400\,000 - 120\,000 &= 280\,000 \\280\,000 - 5\,500 &= 274\,500 \\274\,500 - 45\,000 &= 229\,500 \\229\,500 + 1\,200 &= 230\,700 \\230\,700 - 15\,000 &= 215\,700 \text{ FCFA}\end{aligned}$$

The final balance of 215,700 FCFA is correct. (3 marks)

2. Two anomalies (any two, 2 marks each) :

- The unknown debit "COM*" of 15,000 FCFA on 28/01 : the description is unclear and the customer did not authorize it ; it may be a fraudulent or erroneous debit.
- The monthly bank fees of 5,500 FCFA are unusually high for a current account and should be justified by the bank.
- The interest credit of 1,200 FCFA on a current account is surprising, since current accounts normally earn no interest ; it needs an explanation.

3. Model complaint email (3 marks) :

Subject : Complaint – Unauthorized Debit on Account n° 1002345

Dear Sir/Madam,

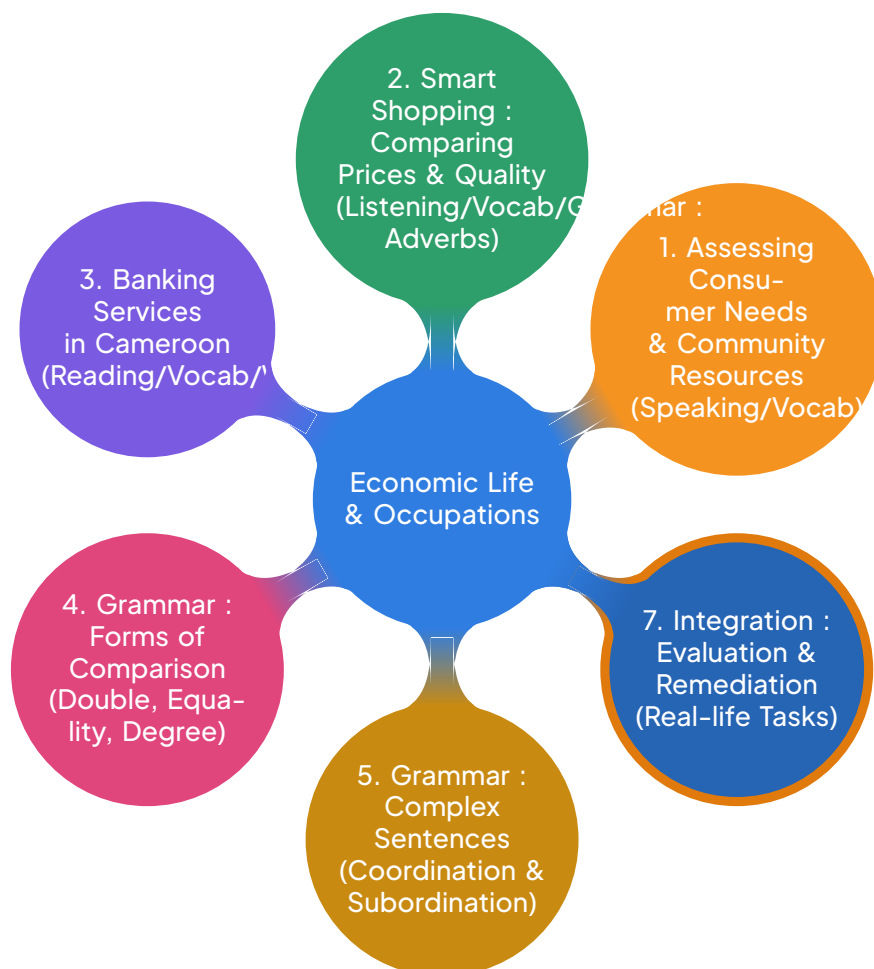
I am writing to complain about anomalies on my January 2026 statement. I would like to draw your attention to an unknown debit labelled "COM*" of 15,000 FCFA on 28/01, which I never authorized, and to monthly fees of 5,500 FCFA that seem excessive. I would rather have these amounts reversed immediately and receive a written explanation. Unless this is rectified within ten days, I will be obliged to refer the matter to the banking regulator. I look forward to your prompt reply.

Yours faithfully,

Mme Ngo Bakang.

Points de vigilance (Part B) : question 1 : montrer toutes les étapes du calcul, pas seulement le résultat ; question 2 : identifier l'anomalie et expliquer pourquoi elle est suspecte ; question 3 : utiliser les trois expressions imposées (I would like to draw your attention to..., I would rather..., Unless this is rectified...) et demander explicitement le remboursement (reversal) et une explication.

12 FICHE BILAN



Mindmap of Lesson 02 : Economic Life and Occupations (Terminale Technique)

FICHE BILAN L'essentiel à connaître pour l'examen

12.1 Key Definitions & Vocabulary

- **Consumer Needs** (Besoins du consommateur) : Goods or services required to satisfy wants (e.g., food, healthcare, banking).
- **Community Resources** (Ressources communautaires) : Local assets available to residents (markets, hospitals, credit unions, vocational centers).
- **Best Buy** (Meilleur achat) : Product offering the best value for money (rapport qualité-prix), not just the lowest price.

- **Banking Services** (Services bancaires) : Savings accounts (compte épargne), current accounts (compte courant), loans (prêts), transfers (virements), mobile money (Mobile Money / Orange Money / MTN MoMo).
- **Comparison** (Comparaison) : Evaluating similarities/differences in price, quality, durability, warranty (garantie).

12.2 Grammar Reference Tables

12.3 Forms of Comparison

Type	Structure	Examples
Equality	as + adjective/adverb + as	This bank is as reliable as that one.
Inequality	not as/so + adjective/adverb + as	Mobile money is not as fast as a wire transfer.
Comparative (Short)	adj+-er + than / more + long adj + than	Cash is cheaper than credit cards.
Superlative	the + adj+-est / the most + long adj	This is the best interest rate.
Double Comparative	The + comparative ..., the + comparative	The more you save, the richer you become.
Parallel Increase	comparative + and + comparative	Prices get higher and higher.

12.4 Adverbs of Time (for, since, ago, after, afterwards)

Adverb	Use / Tense	Example
For	Duration (Period) + Perfect/Cont.	I have had this account for 5 years.
Since	Starting Point + Perfect	She has worked here since 2020.
Ago	Past Point from Now + Past Simple	He opened the account 2 months ago.
After	Preposition / Conjunction (Then)	After signing, you get the card.
Afterwards	Adverb (Later, then)	We applied; afterwards, we waited.

12.5 Complex Sentences : Coordination vs. Subordination

Type	Linkers (Conjunctions)	Structure / Example
Coordination	FANBOYS : For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So	[Ind. Clause] , but [Ind. Clause] I need a loan, but my score is low.
Subordination	Time : when, while, as soon as, before, after, until Reason : because, since, as Condition : if, unless, provided that Contrast : although, even though, whereas Purpose : so that, in order that	When I receive my salary, I save. Because rates are high, I wait. If you sign today, you get a bonus. Although it's far, the service is good. I save so that I can buy a car.

12.6 Expressing Preferences

Structure	Example
Prefer + noun/gerund + to + noun/gerund	I prefer cash to credit cards.
Prefer + full infinitive + rather than + bare infinitive	I prefer to save rather than spend.
Would rather ('d rather) + bare infinitive (+ than)	I 'd rather use Mobile Money than go to the bank.
Would prefer + full infinitive (+ rather than)	I would prefer to talk to a manager.
Better + bare infinitive (advice)	You 'd better check the interest rate.

12.7 Express Methods (Méthodes Express)

MÉTHODE Comparing Prices for Best Buys (Smart Shopping)

1. Identify needs : List exact specs (quantity, quality, features).
2. Gather data : Check 3+ sources (market, supermarket, online, wholesale).
3. Calculate Unit Price : $\frac{\text{Total Price}}{\text{Quantity}}$ (e.g., FCFA/kg, FCFA/litre).
4. Check Hidden Costs : Transport, VAT (TVA), warranty fees, maintenance.
5. Evaluate Quality : Durability, brand reputation, expiry date, certification (ANOR).
6. Decide : Choose best Value for Money (Quality/Price ratio).

MÉTHODE Writing a Formal Letter/Email to a Bank

1. Header : Your Address (Top Right) → Date → Bank Address (Left).
2. Subject Line (Objet) : Clear, bold, caps (e.g., Application for Loan / Complaint : Failed Transfer).
3. Salutation : Dear Sir/Madam, (or Dear Mr. [Name],).
4. Opening : State purpose immediately (I am writing to apply for... / to complain about...).
5. Body (2–3 paragraphs) : Give details (Account n°, dates, amounts). Use Subordination (Because, Although, If) and Coordination (But, So).
6. Call to Action : I would appreciate it if you could... / I look forward to your reply.
7. Closing : Yours faithfully, (if name unknown) / Yours sincerely, (if name known).
8. Signature + Printed Name + Phone Number.

À RETENIR Checklist avant le Bac

- ☐ I can define **Consumer Needs** and **Community Resources** with local examples (Cameroon context).
- ☐ I master the 5 forms of comparison : Equality, Comparative, Superlative, Double

Comparative, Parallel Increase.

- ☐ I distinguish For (duration) vs Since (start point) vs Ago (past simple marker).
- ☐ I distinguish After (prep/conj) vs Afterwards (adverb).
- ☐ I can build Compound sentences using FANBOYS (Coordination) correctly punctuated.
- ☐ I can build Complex sentences using subordinators (Time, Reason, Condition, Contrast, Purpose).
- ☐ I use Preference structures accurately : Prefer X to Y, Would rather V, Would prefer to V.
- ☐ I know key Banking Vocabulary : Deposit/Withdrawal, Interest Rate, Overdraft, Standing Order, Mobile Money, Collateral.
- ☐ I can read a bank statement / loan offer and extract key info (APR/TAEG, maturity, fees).
- ☐ I can write a formal letter/email to a bank (Application, Complaint, Inquiry) with correct layout.
- ☐ I can role-play assessing needs (interviewing a consumer) and comparing prices (shop dialogue).
- ☐ I can justify a Best Buy decision using Value for Money arguments (not just price).

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